Full Truck Alliance (YMM) — Company Primer

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1. Company Overview

1.1 Full Truck Alliance Co. Ltd. (YMM) — Company Primer

Source limitations. Every company figure comes from Full Truck Alliance's own filings and releases: the FY2025 Form 20-F (full document, all items), the Form 6-K earnings releases for Q4 2023 through Q2 2026, investor presentations, Forms 3 and Schedule 13G filings. One gap remains. FTA's own call transcripts contain prepared remarks only, so Q&A remarks from the Q3 2025–Q2 2026 earnings calls come from third-party transcripts. These are marked "secondary" wherever they are used. Industry data in Part 3 rest largely on official statistics, association surveys and commissioned prospectus research, and are labelled accordingly.

Company Overview

Full Truck Alliance (FTA; 满帮集团, Manbang Group) runs China's largest app-based marketplace for road freight. A factory, wholesaler or logistics company with a load to move posts it on FTA's apps (Yunmanman 运满满 and Huochebang 货车帮), and an independent

truck driver, usually an owner-operator, finds and accepts the load on the same app. The company describes its platform as “a digital, standardized and smart freight platform that connects shippers and truckers” [1]. Most of the activity is intercity full-truckload (FTL) freight: one shipper’s goods fill one truck for a trip that averages more than 500 km [2]. The platform also carries less-than-truckload (LTL), intra-city, cold-chain and “entrusted” (managed) freight [2][1]. FTA’s American Depositary Shares trade on the New York Stock Exchange under the ticker YMM; each ADS represents 20 Class A ordinary shares [1]. The holding company is a Cayman Islands company. Its principal executive office is registered in Guiyang, Guizhou, while operations and investor relations are run from Nanjing, and a Shanghai office handles shareholder requests [1]. The founder, Peter Hui Zhang (张晖), is Chairman and Chief Executive Officer. Langbo Guo (President since May 2023, previously chief strategy officer) is in charge of finance, tax, cash planning, strategic planning and operational analysis, and signs the annual report’s financial certification. Simon Chong Cai was CFO from 2020 until May 2025. Since then he has been Chief Financing and Investment Officer, covering financing, investment and investor relations, and he leads the financial discussion on earnings calls [1][3]. No CEO succession has been announced.

The business is large in activity and small in reported revenue, and it makes a lot of cash. In FY2025 (calendar 2025, reported in RMB) the platform handled 236.3 million fulfilled orders, up 19.8%. Average shipper monthly active users (MAUs) were 3.14 million [4]. 4.6 million truckers fulfilled at least one order during 2025, and 4.78 million did so in the twelve months to June 2026. FTA had 1.32 million shippers with active paying memberships at year-end 2025, and 7.23 million users had used at least one value-added service [1][5]. Net revenues were RMB12.49 billion (+11.1%), income from operations RMB4.15 billion, and net income RMB4.46 billion [1]. The company had 8,251 employees at the end of 2025. More than half of them (4,670) sit in sales and marketing, mostly the field operations team FTA calls its “ground force” [1]. It has no borrowings. Cash, deposits and short-term investments stood at RMB31.5 billion at end-2025 and RMB33.4 billion (US$4.9 billion) at June 30, 2026 [4][6]. All revenue is earned in mainland China [1]. In the latest reported quarter (Q2 2026, released August 19, 2026) revenue was RMB3.38 billion (+4.4%), fulfilled orders were 68.5 million (+12.7%), and shipper MAUs were 3.57 million (+12.8%) [6]. Q3 2026 results are scheduled for November 19, 2026 [7].

The core model is an asset-light, two-sided marketplace. FTA owns no trucks and employs no drivers. It earns money in three ways. It charges **shippers** for the right to post loads (membership “freight listing” fees). It charges **truckers** a commission on each load they accept (“transaction service” fees). And where a shipper wants FTA to be the contracting carrier of record, mainly to obtain a VAT invoice, it earns a **brokerage spread** (“freight brokerage”). Around these it sells **value-added services**: consumer-style loans to truckers and small shippers, insurance agency, toll (ETC), fuel and vehicle-related services [1]. The mix has moved sharply toward the trucker commission over the past two years. Transaction service was 34.2% of revenue in FY2024, 42.6% in FY2025 and 52.2% in Q2 2026, while freight brokerage fell from 42.1% to 33.6% to 29.4% [5]. Management’s framing since early 2026 has three parts: a shift “from scale-first growth to balancing quality and scale”; making the company “AI-driven infrastructure for matching, credit, and dynamic pricing”; and building “new growth curves” (overseas expansion under the Qmove brand, and autonomous trucking through its Giga.AI subsidiary) while keeping the core steady [3]. The standing corporate vision, set out at the 2023 Investor Day, is “to become one-stop logistics platform for enterprises” [8].

Segments

FTA reports **one operating and reportable segment**. The chief operating decision maker is the CEO, and the company gives no geographic segment data because all revenue comes from the PRC [1]. Instead it breaks revenue into two service groups and five lines. These lines are the only internal cut the company provides, and they behave very differently from one another.

Revenue line (FY2025)	What it is / who pays	Revenue (RMB m)	% of total	YoY	Recognition
Freight brokerage	FTA acts as contracting party between shipper and trucker; shipper pays; FTA keeps a spread; VAT grossed up	4,199.4	33.6%	-11.2%	Point in time, net (agent)
Freight listing	Shipper membership fees for the right to post orders	980.2	7.8%	+11.4%	Ratably over membership
Transaction service	Trucker commission, a % of the order's freight charge, plus trucker memberships	5,317.2	42.6%	+38.2%	Point in time (commission); ratably (memberships)
Freight matching services subtotal		*10,496.8*	*84.0%*	*+11.0%*	
Credit solutions	Interest and fees on loans to truckers and shippers	1,474.4	11.8%	+9.9%	Over loan life (effective interest)
Other value-added services	Insurance, ETC, fuel and auto agency fees; ADAS kits and services (Giga.AI)	518.7	4.2%	+17.3%	Mainly point in time
Value-added services subtotal		*1,993.1*	*16.0%*	*+11.8%*	
Total net revenues		**12,489.9**	**100%**	**+11.1%**	

Sources: [1] (Note 2, disaggregation of revenues); [4]. Percentages and subtotals computed from reported lines.

Freight brokerage is the largest line by history but the least valuable per renminbi. FTA signs the freight contract with the shipper, issues the VAT invoice, and pays the trucker. Under US GAAP it is an agent, so revenue is the spread between what the shipper pays and what the trucker receives. However, VAT on the full freight value is booked gross, inside revenue, and the matching VAT cost sits in cost of revenues net of local-government grants [1]. The result is a line whose reported revenue is mostly a tax pass-through. Management calls brokerage a "non-core business" with "relatively low margins" that exists for customer stickiness [9][10]. It has been shrinking by design since an August 2025 fee increase [11].

Freight listing is a subscription business. Shippers buy annual membership packages that unlock order posting. It grows slowly (low double digits in 2025, +3.3% in Q2 2026) and carries

deferred revenue: contract liabilities, mainly prepaid memberships, were RMB649.8 million at end-2025 [1][6].

Transaction service is now the core profit engine. It is a percentage commission charged to the trucker on orders that originate in commission-charging cities, and these now include "all eligible cities". About 95% of fulfilled orders paid a commission in Q2 2026 [2][5]. The line grew 66.7% in FY2024 and 38.2% in FY2025, and was +33.1% in each of the first two quarters of 2026 [12][4][6]. Since January 1, 2024 it has also included intra-city revenue that was previously booked in freight listing and value-added services. FY2023 was recast to match [1].

Credit solutions is a lending book, funded mainly from FTA's own capital, extended to truckers and small shippers [1]. It grew through 2025 but has been shrinking deliberately in 2026: the outstanding balance fell 21.9% in the first half to RMB4.3 billion, and value-added services revenue fell 24.9% year on year in Q2 2026, "primarily due to a decrease in credit solutions revenues" [6].

Other value-added services are agency fees from insurers, highway authorities, gas-station operators and vehicle dealers. Since July 2025 they also include sales of advanced driver-assistance (ADAS) kits and ADAS-enabled carrier services from Giga.AI [1].

Realignments that break historical comparisons. There are three. (1) From January 1, 2024, "transaction commission" was renamed "transaction service" and absorbed intra-city revenue. 2023 was recast, and the original and recast FY2023 splits do not reconcile exactly, so this primer uses the recast basis [12][1]. (2) Giga.AI has been consolidated since July 9, 2025, adding revenue to value-added services and cost to R&D [13]. (3) From the FY2025 release (March 12, 2026), the loan balance and non-performing loan (NPL) ratio include off-balance-sheet loans funded by partner institutions on which FTA bears credit risk. December 2024 was restated, but earlier quarters remain on the old basis [4]. Separately, since Q3 2025 the company has given revenue guidance both including and excluding brokerage [14].

How the Business Model Works

The problem the platform solves

China's long-haul road freight is carried mostly by individual owner-operators, and the cargo comes mostly from small and mid-sized shippers. Before apps, the two sides met through roadside "logistics information departments" (信息部) and layers of brokers in freight parks, often over several days (Part 3 covers this). FTA's pitch is that direct matching cuts freight costs by roughly 10–15% compared with traditional channels and cuts matching time from three to five days to under ten minutes (company claim) [5]. The platform's own data support the speed claim. The median matching time was 14 minutes in Q2 2023 and about five minutes in Q2 2026, and the overall fulfillment rate (the share of posted orders that end up matched) rose from about 30% in Q2 2023 to 47.0% in Q2 2026 [8][2][6]. A single trip involves one shipper, one trucker, one freight price agreed between them, and, where monetised, several fee streams for FTA. Following one trip through the system shows where each renminbi of revenue comes from.

Where revenue comes from, mechanically

1. The shipper's membership (freight listing). A shipper downloads the app and, as a non-paying user, can post up to five orders a month. Beyond that it buys a membership. The company offers four main tiers. RMB288 a year allows up to 30 orders, and RMB688 up to 188. RMB1,688 allows up to 2,576 orders and is aimed at high-frequency businesses. RMB3,888 allows up to 9,136 orders over two years and targets ultra-high-volume enterprises. Paying members are sometimes allowed extra free posts as a promotion [1][5]. The RMB288 tier was introduced in early 2024 to monetise low-frequency direct shippers. It passed 300,000 average monthly active members by Q2 2025 and 370,000 by Q3 2025, up more than 300% year on year. About 20% of RMB288 members who hit their order cap upgraded to RMB688 (secondary for the Q3 2025 figures) [15][10]. Paying shipper members passed 1.2 million in Q2 2025, reached 1.27 million in September 2025 (secondary), and stood at 1.32 million with active memberships at December 31, 2025 [15][10][1]. Twelve-month retention of paying shippers was about 80% in 2025. That is measured as the share of January 2025 paying members who were still active shippers in December [1]. In Q1 2026 the posting fee was waived for orders within 200 km, a choice to trade listing revenue for short-haul volume (secondary) [16]. Membership revenue is recognised straight-line over the term, so this line lags the member count and moves slowly [1].

2. The trucker's commission (transaction service). When a trucker accepts an order that originates in a commission-charging city, FTA charges the trucker a fee equal to a percentage of the order's freight charge. It is recognised when the shipper and trucker agree. Where an order has no stated price, FTA charges on a fair-market price estimated by its pricing models [1]. Truckers can instead buy short memberships, usually weekly or monthly, that waive or offset commissions; FTA recognises these ratably [1]. Each online transaction generates an electronic agreement. The trucker pays a freight deposit into an escrow account at a third-party commercial bank, which FTA cannot use. The deposit is released to the shipper or refunded to the trucker when the order completes or is cancelled. In return, truckers get cancellation-fee protection if a shipper cancels while they are en route; most of that fee is recovered from the shipper. FTA also helps truckers collect overdue freight [1]. The 20-F describes "significant opportunities" to extend the fee to more cities and to "raise transaction service fees rate", while noting that this ability "remains untested" [1]. Commissions began in August 2020 in three cities (Hangzhou, Huzhou, Shaoxing). They covered 60 cities and 36.3% of platform GTV by March 2021, 234 cities by Q1 2024, 273 by Q4 2025, and "all eligible cities" by Q2 2026 [17][18][3][2].

Two numbers drive this line: **penetration** (the share of fulfilled orders that pay a commission) and **monetisation per order** (average commission plus trucker-membership revenue per monetised order). Penetration rose from 69.3% in Q1 2023 to 77.4% in Q1 2024, 85.2% in Q1 2025, 88.6% in Q4 2025 and 94.7% in Q2 2026. Average monetisation per order rose from RMB20.4 to RMB22.7, RMB25.5, RMB26.3 (Q4 2025) and about RMB26.9 (Q1 2026) [18][19][3][16][2]. Management attributes part of the 2026 penetration jump to "governance removing low-quality orders" from the denominator rather than to new charging. Newly commissioned orders also start at lower rates, which dilutes the average (secondary) [16]. Pricing is set by city, route, vehicle type and user segment [2]. At the 2023 Investor Day management set out an aspiration, with no time horizon, for "transaction commissions to grow by 10x" through 3x

order volume, 2x take rate on high-value orders and 1.5x penetration [8]. The penetration leg is now close to its ceiling.

3. The brokerage spread and the VAT gross-up (freight brokerage). Many shippers, especially companies and state-owned enterprises, need a VAT invoice for their freight spend so they can deduct input VAT. Individual truckers generally cannot issue one. FTA's consolidated affiliates are licensed "online freight" (网络货运) operators. They contract with the shipper as carrier of record and invoice it for the full freight charge plus FTA's fee. The shipper prepays into its platform account, and after delivery FTA pays the trucker and deducts its service fee, set as a percentage of the shipping fee. The 20-F gives several reasons shippers choose this over contracting a trucker directly: cargo-damage cover of up to RMB20,000 per shipment (backed by cargo insurance in some cases), protection against truckers demanding more money or delivering late, and regulatory compliance, chiefly the VAT invoice [1]. FTA owes VAT, at the 9% transportation rate, on the full selling price, but has little deductible input VAT because the trucker cannot invoice it. Local governments have historically returned part of this VAT as "financial incentives" under cooperation agreements with the operator [1]. The accounting presentation matters. Net revenue is the spread plus the VAT collected, which is grossed up because FTA is primarily responsible for paying it. VAT included in total net revenues was RMB5.10 billion in FY2024 and RMB4.67 billion in FY2025, mostly from brokerage [1]. In cost of revenues, brokerage-related gross VAT was RMB5.01 billion (FY2023), RMB5.61 billion (FY2024) and RMB3.67 billion (FY2025). Tax surcharges, substantially all brokerage-related, added RMB0.89 billion, RMB1.04 billion and RMB0.86 billion. Government grants offset RMB2.47 billion, RMB2.45 billion and RMB1.08 billion; of these, the grants received by the online freight affiliates were RMB2.15 billion, RMB2.10 billion and RMB0.90 billion [1]. Gross brokerage VAT exceeded net brokerage revenue in 2023 and 2024. After the August 2025 fee increase it did not exceed it in 2025 [1]. The company says it sets the brokerage fee rate with its VAT obligation in mind [1].

The August 2025 change follows from this. Grants have been shrinking industry-wide. Logory, a Hong Kong-listed online freight carrier, says local "excess tax burden" subsidies have been disrupted since mid-2025 because no national tax regime for the model has been issued [20]. On January 23, 2026, the Ministry of Transport and the State Taxation Administration issued permanent rules for online freight carrier platforms. The rules require lawful input-VAT deduction, bar false invoicing, and link platform waybill data to the tax authorities [21]. At FTA, a grant receivable of RMB735 million at end-2024 had fallen to nil by end-2025, and the State Council's Regulations on Fair Competition Review (effective August 1, 2024) allow selective local subsidies without a legal basis to be suspended [1]. FTA therefore raised the brokerage service-fee rate from August 2025 and warned that volume would "significantly decline" [11]. Management said the rate was moving to 10–11% as rebates were removed (secondary) [10]. Since Q1 2026 brokerage has run on two tracks. The **self-operated** track keeps a roughly 10% take rate and mainly serves SME shippers that need invoices plus matching; its retained customers are largely state-owned shippers. The **aggregator** track lets licensed third-party partners handle invoicing and settlement while FTA takes a low single-digit channel fee (roughly 1–2%) (secondary) [16][2]. Invoicing-only customers are now a single-digit percentage of brokerage volume, and the model is meant to "reduce our exposure to VAT refund risks" (secondary) [2]. The third-party transcripts disagree on whether the aggregator fee is booked in value-added services (Q1 2026 call) or in brokerage (Q2 2026 call); the company's filings do not

settle it yet [16][2]. For scale, the 2023 Investor Day cited brokerage GTV of about RMB5.4 billion in the month of June 2023, roughly RMB65 billion annualised (our arithmetic) [8].

4. Lending (credit solutions). FTA makes cash loans to truckers and working-capital loans to shippers, typically for less than a year. Most are funded on balance sheet by Huochebang Microfinance, a small-loan company approved to lend online. A small portion of trucker loans is funded by an institutional partner and guaranteed by FTA [1]. Credit limits typically do not exceed RMB50,000 for truckers and RMB100,000 for shippers. The company says it plans "a conservative approach" in response to regulatory developments. Its maximum undiscounted exposure under guarantees was RMB359.1 million at end-2025 [1]. Income is interest and fees recognised over the loan's life. The on-balance-sheet book (principal plus accrued interest) was RMB5.23 billion gross at end-2025, with an allowance of RMB377 million (7.2% of gross). Loans more than 90 days past due were 3.0% of gross, up from 2.1% a year earlier [1]. On the new definition, which includes partner-funded loans, total outstanding was RMB5.5 billion at end-2025 and RMB4.3 billion at June 30, 2026, and the NPL ratio rose from 2.0% (December 2024) to 2.9% (December 2025) to 3.8% (June 2026) [4][6]. All loans were moved to annualised rates of 26% or below by end-2025 "in line with regulatory guidance". The book is shifting toward an asset-light model, with guarantee-backed and facilitated lending funded by partner institutions and less from FTA's own capital (secondary) [3][2].

5. Agency and other services. FTA earns referral and agency fees from insurers (through its licensed broker, Shan'en Insurance Brokerage), from highway authorities (ETC toll cards), from gas-station operators (about 12,000 partner stations, plus a Sinopec agreement covering more than 3,000 stations in Jiangsu, Zhejiang and Anhui), and from automakers and dealers [1][16]. Since July 2025 this line also includes Giga.AI's ADAS kit sales and ADAS-enabled carrier services [1]. In energy, FTA recommends partner gas stations to truckers by location, processes payment in-app, and earns a fee from the station operator as a percentage of the fuel bill. In ETC, it earns account-opening fees from highway authorities or truckers and top-up fees based on transaction value [1]. Exhibit 8.1 lists several "Manbang Energy Technology" entities [22].

Cost structure and unit economics

FTA's P&L has two very different halves, and its cost of revenues is mostly tax.

FY2025 cost line	RMB m	% of revenue	What it is
Cost of revenues	4,618.8	37.0%	VAT, surcharges and other taxes net of grants (RMB3,944.7m); platform-operations payroll; technology service fees; payment-channel commissions
Sales & marketing	1,747.8	14.0%	Advertising (RMB540.7m), sales staff, user-ecosystem

FY2025 cost line	RMB m	% of revenue	What it is
			and “rights protection” spending, trademark amortisation
General & administrative	709.8	5.7%	Executive and administrative staff, SBC (RMB139.8m)
Research & development	874.4	7.0%	Platform engineering, infrastructure, intelligent-driving development (Giga.AI)
Provision for credit solutions	445.4	3.6%	Expected credit losses on the loan book
Income from operations	4,146.2	33.2%	

Sources: [1][4]. Percentages computed.

The 20-F breaks FY2025 cost of revenues into: tax-related costs net of grants, RMB3,944.7 million (85% of the total); platform payroll, RMB248.8 million; technology service fees, RMB235.7 million; payment-channel commissions, RMB88.7 million; and other, RMB100.8 million [1]. The company says it is “not practicable” to allocate costs by revenue line [1]. An illustrative split, using our own arithmetic, takes the brokerage-specific tax items: brokerage VAT RMB3,666.6 million, plus surcharges RMB855.0 million (substantially all brokerage), minus grants RMB1,076.0 million (substantially all brokerage), for a net RMB3,445.6 million. On that basis brokerage earned roughly RMB0.75 billion of gross profit on RMB4.20 billion of revenue in FY2025 (about 18%), against roughly RMB0.53 billion on RMB4.73 billion in FY2024 (about 11%). The non-brokerage lines (RMB8.29 billion of revenue) carried about RMB1.17 billion of remaining cost of revenues, a gross margin of about 86%. These figures are indicative only. They explain why reported gross margin rose from 54.6% in FY2024 to 63.0% in FY2025 and 72.6% in Q2 2026 even as revenue growth slowed: the low-margin line is shrinking and the near-100%-margin commission line is growing [1][6].

Below gross profit, most costs are semi-fixed. People are the main cost. Of 8,251 employees at end-2025, 4,670 (56.6%) were in sales and marketing, 1,801 (21.8%) in customer service and operations, 1,264 (15.3%) in R&D and 516 (6.3%) in G&A [1]. Sales and marketing grew 9.5% in FY2025 against 11.1% revenue growth, G&A fell 22.3%, and R&D was flat despite absorbing Giga.AI from July [4]. Share-based compensation fell from RMB496.6 million (4.4% of revenue) in FY2024 to RMB281.6 million (2.3%) in FY2025, before a Q1 2026 spike to RMB190.1 million [1][23]. The variable costs that scale with activity are payment-processing commissions, a share of customer-service and operations payroll, and, in lending, credit provisions. Incentives paid to users are recorded in sales and marketing where they would otherwise push a customer’s

cumulative revenue negative (RMB201.1 million in FY2025) [1]. Operating margin went from 11.8% (FY2023) to 22.0% (FY2024), 33.2% (FY2025) and 43.9% in Q2 2026 [1][6].

Below operating income, interest income on the cash pile is material: RMB954 million in FY2025, about 18% of pre-tax income (our arithmetic). The effective tax rate rose from 7.1% (FY2024) to 17.2% (FY2025) as preferential-rate savings shrank and withholding tax was accrued on a PRC-to-Hong Kong distribution [1].

The demand engine

Platform volume depends on three things: the amount of road freight moving in China, the share of that freight that is spot-matched rather than contracted, and the share of spot matching that happens on FTA rather than offline. The first is cyclical. It follows industrial production, construction and consumption, and has a strong seasonal dip around Chinese New Year in Q1 (Part 3 covers this). The second and third are structural. Orders on FTA grew about 20–24% a year in 2024–2025 while national road freight volume grew in the low single digits (Part 3). Management describes online penetration of road freight as "extremely low", so platform share gains rather than the freight cycle have been the main driver (secondary) [16].

The orders are not homogeneous. The fastest-growing group, and the one management targets, is **direct shippers**: manufacturers, traders and other cargo owners posting their own loads, as opposed to professional brokers and logistics companies re-posting loads. Direct shippers' share of fulfilled orders rose from 47% in Q1 2024 to 55% in Q4 2025 [18][3]. Direct-shipper orders also match more reliably: their fulfillment rate exceeded 65% in Q2 2026 against 47% for the platform as a whole (secondary) [2]. The 2025–2026 slowdown in order growth, from +22% to +12–14%, was attributed by management mainly to "governance" rather than weaker freight demand. FTA removed fake accounts, loads reposted by middlemen ("freight reselling"), FTL loads misposted as LTL carpooling, and unverified users. Trucker vehicle verification is now close to 100% (secondary) [3]. This is a self-reported explanation. The order data are consistent with it, since fulfillment rates rose throughout, but they cannot prove it.

On the supply side, monthly active truckers responding to orders were roughly 3 million in Q1 2026, and next-month retention of responding truckers has been above 85% in every quarter since Q2 2024 [16][24][5]. The prospectus put the 2020 base at more than 2.8 million truckers fulfilling orders, about 20% of China's 13.7 million heavy- and medium-duty truck drivers at the time [17].

Recurring versus transactional. FTA does not split revenue into recurring and cyclical buckets. In effect, freight listing (7.8% of FY2025 revenue) and trucker memberships inside transaction service (RMB82.7 million) are subscription-like. Credit income runs off a book. The rest, commissions and brokerage, is transactional and moves with order volume [1].

The reinforcing structure

The platform's economics depend on liquidity, and liquidity feeds itself. More shippers posting loads give each trucker more choice of lanes and backhauls, which cuts empty running and waiting time. That attracts more truckers. More truckers raise the probability that a posted load is accepted quickly (fulfillment rate up, matching time down), which brings more

shippers, especially low-frequency direct shippers who have no broker relationship to fall back on. Three features of FTA's design build on this loop.

- **Data, pricing and trust.** Every matched trip adds to a closed-loop record of lanes, prices, trucker behaviour and disputes. FTA uses it for "tap and go" fixed-price orders, assigned first come, first served at prices recommended by its pricing algorithms. Standard orders are priced off the average of recent comparable transactions; others are priced by a machine-learning model (clustering plus LightGBM). The data also feed a knowledge graph of shippers, truckers, trucks, cargo, routes and gas stations; for algorithms that score the probability that a given trucker accepts a given load; for real-time blocking of abnormally low prices and price-reasonableness weighting in matching; for trucker credit ratings and priority access; and for a "Premium Cargo Bidding" mechanism [1][12][10]. Management argues that standalone AI agents cannot copy this, because long-haul matching depends on proprietary transaction data, verified truckers, credit records and dispute handling (secondary) [3].
- **Monetising the trucker side.** Charging truckers a commission works only if the platform's loads are worth more to them than offline alternatives. Penetration rising to about 95% while trucker retention stayed above 85% suggests that, so far, the platform's liquidity has supported the fee [5]. Management also presents trucker protection as part of the loop. Freight-payment protection covers all truckers and more than 90% of listings, alongside empty-run and cargo-damage protection, membership benefits and operating subsidies. In management's words: "protecting reasonable trucker earnings is fundamental to creating a sustainable virtuous cycle" (secondary) [16][2].
- **Adjacent services.** The trucker relationship and transaction data support lending (credit underwriting from platform behaviour), fuel, ETC and insurance referrals. Brokerage, for its part, keeps invoice-needing shippers on the platform [1][10].

The loop is weakest on the trucker side. FTA's own risk factors cite regulatory attention since 2021 to trucker income and possible limits on transaction and membership fees [1]. In May 2021 and again in January 2022, the Ministry of Transport-led joint meeting on new transport formats summoned FTA together with other freight platforms. Its complaints included "maliciously depressing freight rates" and "arbitrarily raising membership fees" [25][26]. Trucker complaints about low prices, freight resellers and dispute handling have also circulated on social media (trade press, secondary) [27]. Part 3 covers this.

Go-to-market

Shipper acquisition runs through app stores and keyword search, offline advertising (high-speed rail and subway stations) and stickers on trucks. Management describes referrals as the "primary driver" of organic growth (secondary) [10]. Advertising spend was RMB540.7 million in FY2025, up from RMB315.7 million in FY2023 [1]. FTA also has a large field team. It calls this "ground force" the main driver of early user acquisition, built by visiting logistics parks town by town, and it remains the front line for new initiatives. Sales and marketing staff numbered 4,670 at end-2025 [1]. Customer service had 1,370 staff, supported by AI-powered automated service [1]. Ratings on both sides carry privileges. Highly rated shippers get some free posts and priority, and highly rated truckers get priority in taking orders [1]. Enterprise and state-owned

shippers come mainly through the brokerage (invoicing) relationship. The freight offering is now packaged as four products: express, entrusted shipping (where FTA manages fulfilment for the shipper), general freight and LTL (secondary) [2]. The model transition under way is in brokerage, from self-operated invoicing to the aggregator channel. Its accounting effect is to shrink reported revenue, which carries a VAT gross-up, much faster than gross profit [16][2].

Key operating metrics and definitions

Metric	Definition (company)	Latest value
Fulfilled orders	All shipping orders matched through the platform in a period, excluding cancelled orders and orders with no specified freight price	68.5m in Q2 2026 (+12.7%); 236.3m in FY2025
Shipper MAUs	Number of active shippers (registered shipper accounts posting at least one order) in a month; average MAUs = sum of monthly MAUs / months	3.57m in Q2 2026; 3.14m FY2025 average
Fulfillment rate	Share of posted orders that are fulfilled (management metric; not defined in filings)	47.0% in Q2 2026 (+6.3pp YoY)
Commission penetration	Share of fulfilled orders on which a transaction service fee is charged	94.7% in Q2 2026
Average monetisation per order	Commission plus trucker-membership fees per monetised order (RMB)	~RMB26.9 in Q1 2026
Active truckers (TTM)	Truckers who fulfilled at least one order in the trailing twelve months	4.78m at June 2026
Loan balance / NPL ratio	Outstanding credit-solutions loans incl. partner-funded loans on which FTA bears risk (excluding loans >180 days past due); NPL = >90 days past due share	RMB4.3bn; 3.8% at June 30, 2026
Non-GAAP adjusted net income	Net income excluding SBC, acquired-intangible amortisation, impairments and one-off items, net of tax	RMB1,433.8m in Q2 2026

Sources: [1][6][5][16][2]. Fulfillment rate, penetration and monetisation per order come from call remarks; values for Q4 2025 onward are from third-party transcripts (secondary) except where the company presentation repeats them.

GTV (gross transaction value) was the headline metric at IPO (RMB173.8 billion in 2020) but has not been disclosed in any 2024–2026 release [17][6].

Funding and capital model

FTA is financed entirely by equity and retained cash. It has no bank borrowings or bonds [1]. The cash pile comes from the 2021 IPO (US$1.57 billion gross plus US$200 million in concurrent private placements) and pre-IPO rounds, and is now being added to by operating cash flow of RMB4.63 billion in FY2025 [17][1]. Of the roughly RMB31 billion of cash and investments at end-2025, only RMB11.1 billion was RMB-denominated, so most of the treasury sits offshore in non-RMB, mainly US dollar, instruments (our inference from the risk-concentration note) [1]. The loan book was historically funded from this cash. The shift to partner-funded, guarantee-backed lending reduces the capital tied up in credit, but FTA keeps the credit risk on guaranteed loans, which is why they now appear in the NPL figures [4][2]. Shareholder returns are set under a January 2026 plan to return at least 50% of the prior year's non-GAAP adjusted net income each year, US$400 million in FY2026 (Part 4) [28].

Products and Services

Product family	Key products / features	Function and demand driver	Monetisation
Freight matching apps	Yunmanman (运满满) and Huochebang (货车帮) shipper and trucker apps	Post, match and track intercity FTL and LTL loads; driven by spot freight volume and online share gains	Shipper membership; trucker commission
Freight products	Express, entrusted shipping, general freight, LTL (four-way split since 2026); "tap and go" pricing; Premium Cargo Bidding	Packages service levels for different shipper needs; entrusted shipping is FTA-managed fulfilment	Commission; brokerage spread where FTA contracts
Cold chain	Yunmanman Cold Chain (52.4%-owned group)	Refrigerated-truck matching; cold-chain orders up nearly 30% in FY2025	Commission; listing
Intra-city	Shengsheng apps (operated via Manyun Software; Jiangsu Yunmanman Tongcheng holds licences)	Short-distance van and truck moves within a city	Within transaction service since 2024
Freight brokerage / invoicing	Self-operated online freight (network freight) operator;	Gives shippers VAT invoices and a single contracting party	Spread (~10% self-operated; low single digit via aggregators)

Product family	Key products / features	Function and demand driver	Monetisation
	aggregator channel via third-party partners (2026)		
Trucker protection & membership	Freight-payment protection, empty-run and cargo-damage protection, trucker credit ratings, priority access, weekly/monthly trucker memberships (“mini-members”, “Carefree” package)	Retain truckers, support fee acceptance	Trucker membership fees
Credit solutions	Loans to truckers and small shippers via microfinance, factoring and guarantee entities	Working capital, fuel and vehicle-related financing	Interest and fees
Insurance, ETC, energy, software	Shan’en Insurance Brokerage (carrier liability, freight, accident and cargo insurance); ETC cards and top-ups; ~12,000 partner gas stations incl. Sinopec cooperation; transportation management system (free for brokerage shippers); traffic-ticket software for truckers	Trucker and shipper operating needs; 7.23m users used ≥1 value-added service (end-2025)	Insurer commissions; fees from highway authorities and top-up fees from truckers; fees from gas stations as a % of fuel cost
AI tools	AI shipper assistant (voice and screenshot posting), matching and fulfilment agents (negotiation, real-time voice, tracking, exception handling), trucker AI assistant,	Lower cost to post and fulfil; higher fulfillment rates	Indirect (higher conversion); no separate pricing disclosed

Product family	Key products / features	Function and demand driver	Monetisation
	AI customer service		
Autonomous / smart trucking	Giga.AI (80.8%-owned) ADAS kits, AI heavy-truck fleet in express and fast-freight; autonomous-delivery pilots	Long-term automation of trunk haulage	ADAS kit sales and carrier services (in other VAS)
Overseas	Qmove apps, launched in Türkiye, Egypt, the UAE and Indonesia (entities also in Singapore and HK)	Replicate the model in markets "similar to China a decade ago"	Not yet monetised

Sources: [1][22][5][29][30][31][16][2][32][15]. Items attributed to Q4 2025–Q2 2026 call Q&A are secondary.

Technology base. The platform runs on two company data centers plus third-party cloud services for computing, storage and bandwidth. Backups are held with a separate cloud provider, and all data are stored in the PRC [1]. At end-2025 FTA held 415 patents, 1,491 registered trademarks and 460 software copyrights in China [1].

Product-mix data. FTA says it primarily serves long-haul FTL shipping and also offers LTL and intra-city services, but it discloses no order split by product (FTL vs LTL vs intra-city vs cold chain) and no brokerage versus non-brokerage order count [6]. Available data points: electric vehicles made up about 20% of first-half 2024 order volume, with EV orders up 100% year on year in Q2 2024, and more than 20% of orders in Q2 2026. Average long-haul distance exceeds 500 km. Cold-chain orders grew nearly 30% in FY2025. LTL orders grew 90% year on year in Q2 2023, and LTL now has nationwide coverage through dedicated-line carriers [24][2][29][8][30].

AI and new products, with traction. AI moved from "exploration to targeted testing" in Q1 2026. The AI posting assistant was piloted with direct shippers, and AI-assisted posts showed fulfillment "materially above average". The core matching and fulfilment agents went live in Q1 2026 (secondary) [16]. By Q2 2026 the shipper AI assistant had been rolled out to a broader base and AI customer service was "fully deployed where applicable" [31]. Management says most completed transactions are now fully automated (secondary, per transcript) [3]. None of this is priced separately. Its effect, if any, would show up in fulfillment rate, matching time and operating cost. Giga.AI's "AI heavy-truck fleet" runs commercially in express delivery and fast-freight lanes [29]. Qmove grew fulfilled orders and fulfillment rate "rapidly" in Q2 2026. The 20-F names Türkiye, Egypt, the UAE and Indonesia as launch markets and calls the business "early stage", but no volumes or financials have been disclosed [31][1].

Brand Portfolio

FTA is a platform rather than a consumer-brand company. Its brands are app brands, each tied to a user base or service.

Brand	Category / target market	Origin / status
Manbang (满帮) / Full Truck Alliance	Corporate group brand	Formed from the 2017 merger
Yunmanman (运满满)	Freight-matching app (shipper and trucker)	Founded 2013 (Jiangsu Manyun); main FTA app
Huochebang (货车帮)	Freight-matching app (shipper and trucker)	Founded 2011 (Guiyang); merged 2017; operated via Shan'en Technology
Yunmanman Cold Chain (运满满冷运)	Refrigerated freight matching	Launched 2021 (Manyun Cold Chain VIE, 52.4%-owned)
Shengsheng (省省)	Intra-city freight matching	New Shengsheng apps since April 2023; previously the Shengsheng Huitouche app
Qmove	Overseas freight-matching brand	Launched in 2025 in Türkiye, Egypt, the UAE and Indonesia; entities also in Singapore and HK
Giga.AI	Smart-truck / autonomous-driving technology	Formerly Plus PRC; consolidated July 2025
Shan'en Insurance Brokerage	Insurance agency for truckers	VIE subsidiary, licensed 2017

Sources: [1][22][17][3].

The two original apps were never merged into one brand. FTA kept both after 2017, and both remain in its self-description [1]. The only acquired brands of note are Huochebang (through the merger), TYT (Beijing Bang Li De Network Technology, an equipment-transportation service acquired in December 2021) and Giga.AI. Giga.AI was acquired in stages from a minority investment, and its consolidation produced RMB821.7 million of goodwill and a RMB401.5 million intelligent-driving technology intangible [1].

Corporate History

The two founding businesses grew out of the informal freight-information trade. Huochebang began in Guiyang in 2011 by brokering freight listings through QQ and WeChat groups. Yunmanman started in Nanjing in 2013, and both launched mobile apps around 2013–2014 [1] [17]. The structurally consequential events since then are:

- **The 2017 merger.** Yunmanman and Huochebang combined to form FTA, and the Cayman holding company was incorporated on December 27, 2017 [17][1]. The merger

ended a subsidy war between the two leading apps. In April 2018 the combined group raised US$1.9 billion in its first post-merger round, co-led by the China Structural Reform Fund and SoftBank Vision Fund (trade press, secondary) [33]. SoftBank still held 7.4% of Class A shares in late 2025, down from 21.1% at end-2021 [34].

- **Monetisation from 2018.** Freight brokerage launched in January 2018 and shipper membership fees in 2018. Trucker commissions began in August 2020 in three cities [17]. These steps took FTA from an information board to a transaction platform and set up today's revenue structure.
- **The June 2021 NYSE IPO and the CAC review.** FTA sold 82.5 million ADSs at US$19.00 (US$1.57 billion gross, all primary), plus US$100 million each from Ontario Teachers' and a Mubadala affiliate in concurrent placements [17]. Less than two weeks after listing, on July 5, 2021, the Cybersecurity Review Office of the Cyberspace Administration of China (CAC) opened a review of the Yunmanman and Huochebang apps and suspended new user registration. Registration resumed on June 29, 2022 [1]. US securities class actions filed from July 7, 2021 were settled for US$10.25 million, with final approval on September 5, 2024 [1]. In May 2022 the SEC named FTA under the HFCAA, and the PCAOB vacated its China determinations in December 2022 [1].
- **Capital-return programme from 2023.** FTA bought back US$147.7 million of shares in 2023 under a US$500 million authorisation [1][35]. It paid its first dividend (US$150 million) in 2024, moved to semi-annual dividends (about US$200 million) in 2025, and in January 2026 adopted a policy of returning at least 50% of prior-year non-GAAP net income, US$400 million in FY2026 [36][12][28].
- **The 2025 brokerage reset.** On August 1, 2025 FTA raised its brokerage service-fee rate to reduce dependence on local-government grants, accepting a large loss of brokerage volume [11]. Combined with the 2026 shift to the aggregator channel, this is the largest change to the revenue model since commissions were introduced.
- **Autonomous trucking: Plus to Giga.AI.** FTA was an equity investor in PlusAI. In July 2023 PlusAI split into a China entity (Plus PRC, now Giga.AI) and a US entity (Plus Automation), and FTA received preferred shares in both [1]. FTA lent Giga.AI US$5 million at 12% in 2024 (repaid). It bought US$20 million of 12% convertible notes in May 2024 and US$16 million more in January 2025 [1]. A RMB352.7 million impairment in Q4 2024 related to credit impairment on an investment in an investee that could not meet redemption requests [1]. In May 2025 the board approved a further US$125 million investment [37]. On July 9, 2025, FTA paid US$85 million in cash and converted US$40 million of notes and interest, taking 69.9% of equity and board control, and consolidated the business [1]. A further US$20 million purchase from Plus Automation in September 2025 took the stake to 80.8%, and FTA still holds 17.2% of Plus Automation [1]. Among the executives in FTA's May 2025 US$37.5 million repurchase of vested shares, Peter Hui Zhang used all of his net proceeds to buy Giga.AI preferred shares [1].

Leadership has been stable. Peter Hui Zhang has led Yunmanman since its founding in November 2013, has been a director of the combined group since December 2017 and CEO since December 2018, and controls 77.2% of shareholder votes through his 2.10 billion Class B shares [1]. The 2017 merger itself was structured as a consolidation of the two Cayman holding companies (Full Truck Logistics Information Co. and Truck Alliance Inc.). A 2021 reorganisation

reshaped the VIE structure into today's three VIEs (Manyun Software, Shan'en Technology, Manyun Cold Chain) [1].

Facilities. FTA leases about 41,178 m^2 of offices in Nanjing, plus offices in Beijing, Shanghai, Suzhou and other cities. It owns a 10,717 m^2 office building in Guiyang. It is building a Nanjing headquarters on a 21,817 m^2 plot. The building will provide about 120,000 m^2 of space at an estimated cost of RMB0.8 billion, of which RMB248.4 million had been paid by end-2025, with completion expected in the second half of 2027 [1].

Management. The 20-F lists the following directors and executive officers [1]:

Name	Age	Role	Background
Peter Hui Zhang	47	Founder, Chairman (since Nov 2020), CEO (since Dec 2018)	Founded Yunmanman (CEO 2013–2018); Alibaba regional sales and customer management 2005–2011
Langbo Guo	54	President and Director (since May 2023)	Chief strategy officer 2018–2023; senior director at Baidu 2011–2018
Simon Chong Cai	43	Chief Financing and Investment Officer (since May 2025)	CFO 2020–May 2025 (Yunmanman CFO from 2017); 12+ years in investment banking (Nomura, Citi, Morgan Stanley)
Kai Shen	45	Chief Public Affairs and Risk Officer (since Apr 2025)	Chief risk officer and general counsel from Oct 2019; Alibaba legal 2011–2019
Guizhen Ma	44	Director; chief cultural officer and VP of HR	Founding member of Yunmanman; Alibaba B2B HR 2005–2013
Richard Weidong Ji	58	Director	Co-founder of All-Stars Investment; ex-Morgan Stanley research MD
Shanshan Guo	46	Independent Director (director since 2017)	Venture partner, HongShan (formerly Sequoia China)
Jennifer Xinzhe Li	58	Independent	Former Baidu CFO;

Name	Age	Role	Background
		Director; audit committee chair	boards of ABB and SAP

Directors and executive officers received aggregate cash compensation of about RMB23.2 million in 2025 [1]. Equity awards are mostly near-zero-strike options under the 2021 Plan; 247.5 million were outstanding at March 31, 2026 [1]. Two of the six directors are independent. Using home-country practice exemptions, the compensation and nominating committees have no independent members, and FTA is not required to hold annual shareholder meetings [1].

Ownership and control. Beneficial ownership at March 31, 2026, as reported in the 20-F:

Holder	Shares	% of total shares	% of votes
Peter Hui Zhang (Full Load Logistics; all Class B)	2,100.7m Class B + 17 Class A	10.1%	77.2%
All directors and executive officers as a group	590.2m Class A + 2,100.7m Class B	13.0%	77.9%
— of which Richard Weidong Ji (All-Stars entities)	493.4m Class A	2.4%	0.6%
First Beijing Investment Ltd	1,532.3m Class A (at Dec 31, 2025)	7.4%	1.9%
SoftBank Vision Fund (SVF Truck)	1,386.0m Class A (at Sep 30, 2025)	6.7%	1.7%
FIL Limited (Fidelity International)	1,266.8m Class A (at Sep 30, 2025)	6.1%	1.6%
Invesco Ltd.	1,084.5m Class A (at Sep 30, 2025)	5.2%	1.3%

Source: [1] (Item 6.E). Shares outstanding at March 31, 2026 were 20.75 billion (18.65bn Class A, 2.10bn Class B). Class B carries 30 votes per share. A later Schedule 13G/A shows First Beijing at 1,800.0m Class A shares (9.6% of Class A) as of March 31, 2026 [38].

FTA is a “controlled company” under NYSE rules. The founder’s voting control was 83.4% at the IPO [17]. SoftBank’s stake has fallen from 21.1% of Class A at end-2021 [34]. No current Tencent holding above 5% is reported.

2. Company Logistics

2.1 Customers and Distribution

Who Are the Customers

FTA serves a two-sided market, and its accounting treats both sides as customers. Shippers are the "primary customers" for freight brokerage and freight listing. Truckers pay transaction-service fees and trucker memberships. Both are treated as customers when the company accounts for incentives [1]. There is no customer concentration. The 20-F's risks-and-concentrations note has no customer-concentration disclosure and no customer above 10% of revenue, which fits a base made up of millions of small shippers and individual drivers [1]. No customers are named in any filing reviewed.

A useful first cut is **who actually pays each renminbi of revenue**:

Payer	Revenue lines	FY2025 revenue (RMB m)	% of total	Q2 2026 share
Shippers	Freight brokerage (spread + VAT gross-up) and freight listing (membership)	5,179.6	41.5%	36.8%
Truckers	Transaction service (commission + trucker memberships)	5,317.2	42.6%	52.2%
Truckers and shippers (borrowers)	Credit solutions	1,474.4	11.8%	10.9%*
Third parties (insurers, highway authorities, gas stations, dealers) and ADAS buyers	Other value-added services	518.7	4.2%	(in VAS)

*Sources: [1][5]. Shares computed. *Q2 2026 figure is total value-added services (credit plus other); the split is not given quarterly. Brokerage revenue includes VAT collected on the full freight value, so the shipper share overstates FTA's economic take from shippers.*

The trucker became FTA's largest paying customer group during 2025. That is the most important change in the customer mix over the period covered, and it follows from the rise in commission penetration and the shrinking of brokerage described in Part 1.

Shippers. The 20-F describes the shipper base as third-party logistics companies, direct shippers and truck brokers across many industries, from small business owners to express-delivery companies and manufacturers [1]. FTA had 3.14 million average shipper MAUs in FY2025 and 3.57 million in Q2 2026 [4][6]. The company splits shippers along two lines.

- *Direct shippers versus professional shippers.* Direct shippers are cargo owners: manufacturers, traders, wholesalers and other SMEs posting their own loads. Professional shippers are logistics companies, freight forwarders and brokers ("information departments") that consolidate and repost loads. Direct shippers' share of fulfilled orders rose every quarter, from 47% in Q1 2024 to 55% in Q4 2025 [18][3]. Management describes the long-term target customer as "millions of SME direct shippers with on-demand, fragmented needs" (secondary) [2]. On the company's framing there are more than 30 million SMEs in China [5].
- *By frequency, which is how membership is priced.* Low-frequency shippers can post five orders a month free, or buy the RMB288 tier (up to 30 orders a year). Mid-frequency shippers buy RMB688 (up to 188 orders). High-frequency, professional shippers buy RMB1,688 (up to 2,576 orders a year), and ultra-high-volume enterprises buy RMB3,888 (up to 9,136 orders over two years) [1][5]. In Q3 2025 active RMB288 members grew more than 300% year on year to over 370,000, while active RMB1,688 high-frequency shippers declined (secondary) [10]. That is consistent with the platform's mix moving from brokers toward direct shippers, and with the governance campaign against freight resellers.
- *Enterprise and state-owned shippers.* These are reached mainly through the brokerage (invoicing) product. Management says the customers retained in self-operated brokerage after the August 2025 fee increase are largely state-owned shippers. SME shippers needing "invoicing plus matching" make up more than 70% of brokerage orders, and shippers that wanted only a VAT invoice were the ones that churned (secondary) [10][16].

Paying shipper members passed 1.0 million in Q4 2024 and 1.2 million in Q2 2025, and stood at 1.32 million active paying memberships at December 31, 2025 [39][15][1]. Twelve-month retention of paying shippers was about 80% in 2025. The 20-F defines it as January 2025 paying members still active in December 2025, divided by December paying members [1]. The prospectus put the 2021 base at about 1.4 million shippers posting orders in March 2021 and more than 1.3 million shipper MAUs in December 2020 [17].

Truckers. Truckers are not FTA employees. Most are individual owner-operators, with vehicles ranging from 1.8-metre minivans to 17.5-metre heavy trucks. The main body types are dry vans (higher-value consumer goods), flatbeds (steel plate and coil) and stake-body trucks (boxed and light cargo), plus refrigerated, dump, low-bed and wing trucks [1]. By length, 4.2-metre trucks (up to 2.5 tonnes) serve short-to-medium hauls, 6.8–9.6-metre trucks (8–19 tonnes) medium-to-long hauls, and 13–17.5-metre trucks (25–33 tonnes) long hauls [1]. In 2025, 4.6 million truckers fulfilled orders on the platform [1].

Trucker metric	Value	Period	Source
Truckers who fulfilled ≥1 order,	4.78m	June 2026	[5]

Trucker metric	Value	Period	Source
trailing 12 months			
— same, earlier readings	3.91m (Mar 2024); 4.14m (Dec 2024); 4.48m (Sep 2025)		[18][39][9]
Monthly active truckers responding to orders	~3m, "steady"; +~5% YoY in Q2 2026	Q1–Q2 2026	[16][2] (secondary)
Next-month retention of responding truckers	>85%	every quarter Q2 2024–Q2 2026	[24][5]
Trucker members	~1m; ~30% of long-haul trucker MAUs, carrying >40% of long-haul volume	Q3 2025	[15][10] (secondary)
Vehicle verification	close to 100%	Q4 2025	[3] (secondary)

Truckers are customers in the commission sense: they pay to take loads. In freight brokerage, however, FTA pays them. There the trucker is the de facto subcontractor and the payment is netted out of revenue [1]. This dual role, customer on most orders and subcontractor on brokerage orders, is unusual. It is one reason the company's protection measures (freight-payment protection for all truckers and more than 90% of listings, empty-run and cargo-damage cover) are presented as part of the product rather than as cost (secondary) [16].

End-market mix. The 20-F lists the principal cargo categories matched on the platform: fresh produce, grain and grain products, other agricultural produce, metals, minerals, construction materials, industrial chemicals and plastics, and machinery [1]. It gives no percentages by cargo type, shipper industry or distance band. Other data points are partial. Average long-haul distance is above 500 km. EVs account for more than 20% of orders, which in practice means shorter and intra-city moves. Cold-chain orders grew nearly 30% in FY2025 [2][29]. Management's commentary on Q2 2026 said high diesel prices from late March to May hurt "low-value freight", which suggests a meaningful share of bulk and commodity-type loads, but no split is given (secondary) [2]. CFLP's monthly freight-rate commentary links heavy-goods demand to construction and lighter freight to consumption (Part 3) [40].

Retention and engagement. The company reports retention only as thresholds: >85% next-month retention for responding truckers and ~80% twelve-month retention for shipper members. It gives no cohort data or net revenue retention [5][1]. In December 2025, next-month retention of truckers who responded to orders was above 85% [1].

Distribution Channels

FTA has one distribution channel in the usual sense: its own apps (iOS, Android, WeChat mini-programs). All matching happens there. The meaningful channel questions are how users are acquired, and how the brokerage product is delivered.

User acquisition. Shippers come through app-store and keyword search, offline advertising (high-speed rail and subway stations), stickers on trucks, and referrals. Management calls referrals the "primary driver" of organic growth (secondary) [10]. Advertising spend was RMB315.7 million in FY2023, RMB508.3 million in FY2024 and RMB540.7 million in FY2025 [1]. FTA also runs a large field team, its "ground force" (4,670 sales and marketing staff at end-2025), which built the user base by canvassing logistics parks and still handles new-initiative rollouts. Customer service had 1,370 staff, supplemented by AI-powered automated service [1]. There is no reseller or agent network. Historically the "channel" FTA displaced was the offline broker. Brokers are still users of the platform, as professional shippers buying the RMB1,688 tier, and their declining share of orders is itself a channel shift [5][3].

Brokerage delivery: self-operated and aggregator. Since Q1 2026 freight brokerage has been delivered two ways (secondary) [16][2].

Track	Who contracts and invoices	FTA take	Who it serves	Direction
Self-operated	FTA's online freight carrier entities	~10% service fee (raised from August 2025 as grants fell)	SME shippers needing invoicing plus matching; retained base mainly state-owned shippers	Shrinking by choice
Aggregator	Licensed third-party online freight platforms handle invoicing and settlement	Low single-digit channel fee (~1–2%)	Shippers that still need invoices	Growing; FTA "will continue shifting" toward it

Source: Q1 and Q2 2026 call Q&A, third-party transcripts (secondary) [16][2]. Revenue classification of the aggregator fee is reported inconsistently between the two calls.

The economics of the shift: FTA keeps the matching (and the trucker commission) while handing off the tax-intensive invoicing leg to partners. It gives up the VAT-inclusive revenue and accepts a much lower take. Invoicing-only customers are now a single-digit percentage of volume, and management says the model reduces "exposure to VAT refund risks" (secondary) [2].

Channel and engagement KPIs.

KPI	Q2 2024	Q2 2025	Q4 2025	Q1 2026	Q2 2026
Shipper MAUs (m)	2.65	3.16	3.28	3.11	3.57
Direct shippers' share of fulfilled orders	48%	53%	55%	rising (n/d)	rising (n/d)

KPI	Q2 2024	Q2 2025	Q4 2025	Q1 2026	Q2 2026
Fulfillment rate	~33.7%	40.7%	42.7%	44.1%	47.0%
Commission penetration	81.1%	86.7%	88.6%	>94%	94.7%
Median matching time	—	—	—	"near historic lows"	~5 minutes

Sources: [41][14][4][23][6][24][15][5]; Q4 2025–Q2 2026 fulfillment, penetration and matching time from call Q&A (secondary) [3][16][2]. n/d = not disclosed.

Incentives that change behaviour. These include the free tier for up to five orders a month and the waiver of posting fees for orders under 200 km (Q1 2026) [5][16]; trucker memberships that convert per-order commissions into a weekly or monthly fee [1]; "operating subsidies" to truckers and price floors that block abnormally low bids [2][10]; and, on fuel, a fuel-price link that raises reference rates and bidding floors when diesel rises (secondary) [16]. User incentives recorded in sales and marketing were RMB201.1 million in FY2025 [1].

2.2 Suppliers and Procurement

FTA buys no freight capacity in the traditional sense and holds no inventory. Its "inputs" fall into five groups: (1) the trucker capacity it intermediates, which it pays for only in brokerage, and nets out of revenue there; (2) taxes, specifically non-deductible VAT on brokerage, offset by local-government grants; (3) technology services (servers, cloud, bandwidth); (4) payment-channel services; and (5) staff. The 20-F lists cost of revenues as VAT and surcharges net of grants, platform-operations payroll, technology service fees and commissions to third-party payment platforms [1].

Cost of revenues (RMB m)	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	Share of FY2025 COR
VAT, tax surcharges and other taxes, net of grants	3,693.5	4,584.4	3,944.7	85.4%
— of which gross VAT (brokerage-related)	5,271.1 (5,006.4)	5,996.2 (5,608.2)	4,165.7 (3,666.6)	
— of which surcharges and other taxes	893.4	1,039.6	855.0	
— less government grants	(2,471.0)	(2,451.4)	(1,076.0)	
Payroll for platform-operations staff	161.9	208.0	248.8	5.4%
Technology service fees	155.2	209.8	235.7	5.1%
Commissions to third-party payment platforms	101.4	83.7	88.7	1.9%
Other	7.0	14.7	100.8	2.2%
Total cost of revenues	**4,119.0**	**5,100.6**	**4,618.8**	**100%**

Source: [1] (Item 5.A). Surcharges and grants are "substantially all" brokerage-related per the filing. Shares computed.

Local governments as a quasi-supplier. The most important "supply" relationship in the P&L is with local governments. FTA's online freight entities receive grants linked to the VAT they pay, under cooperation agreements negotiated with each local authority rather than under formal statutory policy. They are "not guaranteed", and several authorities have reduced them [1]. Grants received by the online freight affiliates fell from RMB2,150.1 million (2023) and RMB2,102.8 million (2024) to RMB903.3 million (2025). Total grants netted in cost of revenues fell from RMB2,471.0 million (2023) and RMB2,451.4 million (2024) to RMB1,076.0 million (2025) [1]. A grant receivable of RMB735.4 million at end-2024 was nil at end-2025 [1]. Secondary reporting put Q1 2025 grants at RMB467 million, down 41% year on year [42]. In Q2 2026, tax-related costs net of grants in cost of revenues were RMB743.4 million, against RMB1,087.1 million a year earlier, as brokerage volume shrank [6]. The 20-F does not name the provinces or cities involved.

Technology and payments. The platform runs on two company data centers plus third-party cloud services for computing, storage, bandwidth and backup. Primary data sit in two MySQL-based cloud databases, with backups at a separate cloud provider, and all data are stored in the PRC [1]. Vendors are not named. Technology service fees were RMB235.7 million in FY2025 (+12.4%), and commissions paid to third-party payment platforms were RMB88.7 million (+6.0%, as fee rebates from those platforms fell) [1]. Trucker deposits are held in escrow at a third-party commercial bank [1]. Funds receivable from third-party payment channels were RMB120.6 million at end-2025 [1]. Suppliers must sign a Data Security Confidentiality Agreement, and all outbound data transfers require internal approval [1]. No supplier concentration is disclosed [1].

Financial-institution partners. The credit business is moving from own-funded lending to partner-funded loans guaranteed by FTA's financing-guarantee subsidiaries (Nanjing Manyun non-Financing Guarantee, Tianjin Manbang Financing Assurance) [22][4]. The 20-F describes a single "institutional funding partner" funding a small portion of trucker cash loans; the large majority of loans are funded by FTA's own small-loan company. FTA's maximum undiscounted guarantee exposure was RMB359.1 million at end-2025 [1]. Loan pricing is capped at an annualised 26% under regulatory guidance (secondary) [3]. The 20-F flags PBOC and NFRA guidance since 2025 that may cap maximum loan rates [1].

Distribution partners for value-added services. Insurers (through Shan'en Insurance Brokerage), highway authorities (ETC), about 12,000 partner gas stations including a Sinopec cooperation covering more than 3,000 stations in Jiangsu, Zhejiang and Anhui, and automakers and dealers [1][16]. These are revenue partners, paying FTA agency fees, rather than suppliers.

Commodity exposure. FTA has no direct commodity input costs. It is exposed indirectly to **diesel**. Fuel is roughly 30–50% of a trucker's operating cost (trade press, secondary) [43], so diesel price spikes squeeze trucker economics, push low-value freight off the road, and raise political sensitivity around platform fees. Management cited high diesel prices from late March to May 2026 as a drag on low-value freight, with recovery after price cuts from June (secondary) [2]. In Q1 2026, conversely, fuel volatility pushed shippers from offline channels onto the platform (secondary) [16].

Vertical integration and long-term contracts. FTA's main vertical steps are into autonomous-truck technology (Giga.AI, 80.8% owned) and energy services. Giga.AI sells ADAS

kits; its hardware supply chain is not described [1]. Capital commitments, mainly for construction of an office building, were RMB200 million at end-2025 [1]. No long-term supply contracts with expiry dates are disclosed.

Tariffs and trade. FTA has no direct tariff exposure; all revenue is domestic and it imports no goods of note. Indirectly, export-oriented manufacturing is part of the freight base, but the company gives no sensitivity.

2.3 Geographic Distribution

All revenue is earned in mainland China. The 20-F gives no geographic disclosure because all revenue is from the PRC [1]. Within China, FTA discloses no split of revenue, orders or users by province or region.

Geography	FY2023 revenue (RMB m)	FY2024 revenue (RMB m)	FY2025 revenue (RMB m)	Share	Notes
Mainland China	8,436.2	11,238.6	12,489.9	100%	No provincial split disclosed
Overseas (Qmove)	—	—	—	~0%	Pre-monetisation; no revenue disclosed

Sources: [1][4][3].

Domestic footprint, by proxy. The platform claims coverage of more than 300 cities, every prefecture-level city, and more than 100,000 routes [5]. Commissions were rolled out city by city: Hangzhou, Huzhou and Shaoxing in August 2020, 60 cities by March 2021, 234 by Q1 2024 and 273 by Q4 2025 [17][18][3]. That sequence suggests the most liquid, earliest-monetised markets are the Yangtze River Delta manufacturing belt, but no regional revenue is given. Corporate presence is spread across Guiyang (registered head office and the Huochebang heritage), Nanjing (operating head office), Beijing (Beijing Zhihui Yunli and TYT) and Shanghai (IR office) [1][22]. The geographic distribution of FTA's brokerage entities, and so of its grant exposure, is not disclosed. Grants are negotiated locally and vary by province [1].

Regional dynamics. Management commentary does not discuss regional growth differences. The only regional references in the sources reviewed are the Sinopec fuel cooperation in Jiangsu, Zhejiang and Anhui, and the note that extreme weather is a near-term operating risk (secondary) [16][2].

Overseas: Qmove. FTA's overseas business runs under the Qmove brand. It launched in 2025 in selected markets, which the 20-F names as Türkiye, Egypt, the UAE and Indonesia, and the filing describes it as at an "early stage of development" [1]. Exhibit 8.1 also lists Qmove entities in Singapore and Hong Kong [22]. The CEO said in May 2026 that Qmove operates in four international markets [30]. Management describes the overseas effort as at the "model validation and capability replication" stage, in markets that resemble China a decade ago. The priority is network density, then disciplined city expansion, with no monetisation timeline (secondary) [3]. Qmove's fulfilled orders and fulfillment rate grew "rapidly" in Q2 2026 [31]. "Overseas expansion" is listed among the company-specific risk factors [1].

Currency exposure. Operating revenue and costs are in RMB. The balance sheet is not. At end-2025, RMB-denominated cash, restricted cash and investments were RMB11,067.7 million,

out of total cash and investments of about RMB31.5 billion [1][4]. The rest, about RMB20 billion, is held in non-RMB, predominantly US dollar, instruments (our inference). This is mainly IPO and pre-IPO capital held offshore. It matters for three reasons. Interest income depends partly on US dollar rates. Translation moves pass through other comprehensive income: accumulated OCI fell from RMB3.22 billion to RMB2.74 billion in 2025. And dividends are declared and paid in US dollars [1]. The 20-F reports cash moving between the Cayman parent and PRC subsidiaries in both directions: the parent sent RMB8.9 billion to subsidiaries and received RMB7.3 billion back in 2025. No dividends were paid from PRC subsidiaries to the Cayman parent in 2023–2025. In 2025, certain PRC subsidiaries paid a RMB0.8 billion cash dividend to Lucky Logistics Information (Hong Kong), which was reinvested in the PRC business [1]. At end-2025, cash and cash equivalents held outside the PRC were about US$214 million, almost all in US dollars. Inside the PRC, subsidiaries held RMB3.68 billion and US$19.4 million, and the VIEs held RMB744 million [1]. Most of the remaining treasury sits in short-term investments and long-term deposits.

3. Industry Overview

3.1 Industry Overview

Introduction

Road freight is the main way goods move around China. Trucks carried 43.3 billion tonnes of freight in 2025, 72.5% of all freight tonnage across road, rail, waterway and air. Because road hauls are shorter than rail or water hauls, trucks accounted for a much smaller share of tonne-kilometres: 7.95 trillion tonne-km, about 29% of the national total (shares are our arithmetic from NBS figures) [44]. The industry sells transport, the movement of a load from origin to destination. Its customers range from state-owned steel mills and automakers to millions of small manufacturers, wholesalers and e-commerce sellers.

The economic reason the industry exists, and the reason platforms like FTA exist inside it, is fragmentation on both sides. In 2022 China had 3.10 million registered road freight operators, and 83.5% of them were individual operators (个体户) rather than companies (China Road Transport Association data, secondary) [45]. Industry compilations estimate that about 87% of road transport entities own fewer than ten trucks (vendor compilation, secondary) [46]. The China Federation of Logistics and Purchasing (CFLP) estimates there are about 38 million truck drivers in China, handling more than 70% of freight volume. More than 60% of them are individual owner-operators (association survey) [47]. Shippers are just as scattered. Most cargo comes from SMEs that ship irregularly, on lanes that change week to week, and they cannot justify dedicated fleets or long-term contracts. Historically, layers of intermediaries brought the two sides together, and the government's 2024 logistics-cost action plan still describes road freight operators as "small, scattered and weak" (小、散、弱) [48].

The industry matters to policymakers because logistics is a large cost to the economy. Total social logistics cost, which covers all modes plus storage and administration, was RMB19.5 trillion in 2025, or 13.9% of GDP. That was down from 14.1% in 2024, and CFLP describes it as the lowest ratio since its records began [49][50]. The ratio held at 13.9% in the first half of 2026 [51]. The State Council's November 2024 action plan targets a ratio of about 13.5% by 2027. It

singles out the fragmented road-freight base, differentiated highway tolls, digitalisation and standards for "online freight and other new models" as levers [48]. Digital freight platforms therefore sit inside an explicit national cost-reduction agenda, and they are regulated with that in mind.

Industry Size

Physical volume (official statistics).

Year	Road freight volume (bn tonnes)	YoY	Road share of all-mode tonnes	Road freight turnover (tn tonne-km)	YoY	Road share of tonne-km
2022	37.12	-5.5%	72.1%	6.90	-1.2%	29.8%
2023	40.34	+8.7%	72.4%	7.40	+6.9%	29.9%
2024	41.88	+3.8%	72.4%	7.68	+3.9%	29.3%
2025	43.29	+3.4%	72.5%	7.95	+3.5%	29.0%
H1 2026	21.22	+3.2–3.4%	—	3.90	+3.2%	—

Sources: [52][53][54][44]; 2025 also confirmed by the Ministry of Transport bulletin [55]; H1 2026 from a compilation of NBS/MOT monthly data (secondary) [56]. Growth rates are on NBS's "comparable basis" (the MOT changed statistical scope in 2024). Shares computed.

At the end of 2025 the MOT counted 11.69 million operating freight vehicles: 3.89 million rigid trucks, 3.94 million tractor units and 3.86 million trailers. Of these, 336,100 were new-energy vehicles, about 2.9% of the stock (our arithmetic) [55].

Market value (third-party estimates). There is no official figure for road freight spend. The estimates below come from commissioned prospectus research and differ mainly in scope.

Estimate	Year	Source	Scope / definition
RMB6.2tn (US$951.5bn)	2020	CIC for FTA's IPO prospectus	Total China road transportation market
RMB5.3tn → RMB6.5tn (≈4.2% CAGR, computed)	2020 → 2025E	CIC for FTA's IPO prospectus	Full-truckload plus less-than-truckload segments only
US$1,106.5bn (31.8% of global)	2022	CIC figures (Lalamove 2023 prospectus), via vendor compilation	China road freight GTV incl. intra-city, inter-city, express
US$1,340.3bn (33.7% of global); 5.3% CAGR to 2030E	2025	Frost & Sullivan for Lalatech (Lalamove/Huolala) HKEX filing	China road freight GTV, all segments
— of which inter-city US$784.3bn (2.5% CAGR); intra-city US$281.0bn (7.6%	2025	Frost & Sullivan (same)	Segment cuts; the residual to the total is not explained in the excerpt reviewed

Estimate	Year	Source	Scope / definition
CAGR)			(likely express and other)
~RMB7tn: express ~1.5tn; FTL & LTL ~5.5tn (spot ~3tn, contracted ~2.5tn)	c.2022	FTA 2023 Investor Day (company estimate)	Vendor-sourced framing by FTA; approximate, slide layout garbled

Sources: [57][46][58][8]. All are vendor or company estimates, not official statistics.

The figures look further apart than they are. CIC's RMB6.2 trillion (2020) and Frost & Sullivan's US$1.34 trillion, about RMB9.6 trillion at RMB7.15 per dollar (our conversion), measure different things. The Frost & Sullivan figure is "GTV" across intra-city, inter-city and express segments, while CIC's figure is road transportation spend for FTA's prospectus. Five years of nominal growth also separate them. The segment that matters most for FTA, intercity FTL and LTL, is about RMB5.3–5.5 trillion on both CIC's and FTA's own framing, and Frost & Sullivan's inter-city cut (about US$784 billion, roughly RMB5.6 trillion) is consistent with that. All three put intercity growth at low-to-mid single digits: 4.2% for CIC 2020–25E and 2.5% for Frost & Sullivan 2025–30E. FTA's own split, if taken at face value, implies about RMB3 trillion of spot (uncontracted) intercity freight. That is the pool on-demand matching platforms address most directly [8].

Online penetration. Estimates of how much road freight is already transacted digitally are thin and inconsistent.

- A survey cited by People's Daily put online freight platforms at about 10% of national road transport fees in 2023 [59].
- A vendor compilation put licensed online freight platform revenue at RMB93.0 billion in 2024. Of this, RMB54.8 billion was intercity FTL, RMB11.6 billion intra-city FTL and RMB26.6 billion LTL (vendor estimate, secondary) [60].
- Frost & Sullivan estimates intra-city online penetration at 4.7% in 2025, rising to 6.0% by 2030, and puts 2.6% of global road freight GTV through digital platforms [58].
- The MOT said in 2024 that nearly 10 million truck drivers find loads via platforms [61]. CFLP's 2025 survey found 57.4% of individual owner-operators use digital freight platforms to find cargo [47].

The low revenue-penetration figures and the high driver-usage figures can both be true. Many drivers use apps to find loads, but most freight value is still contracted offline or settled outside a platform's payment loop. FTA management describes long-haul online penetration as "extremely low" (secondary) [16].

How the Industry Works

The traditional value chain. In the offline model, a factory without its own fleet hands a load to a local logistics "information department" (信息部) at a freight park. The information department may pass the load to other brokers or post it on a blackboard and phone round for an owner-operator. A 2018 field report from Hefei and Jinhua describes the mechanics. Brokers earned the spread between the factory's price and the trucker's pay, plus a driver-paid

information fee of RMB200–500 per order. They advanced freight to drivers because factory payment terms were longer than driver settlement. Backhaul loads paid one-third to one-half less than outbound loads, and drivers could wait days for one (press, secondary) [62]. CIC estimated middlemen fees at "typically 10–15% of the freight fees paid by shippers" [57]. The model's costs are time (waiting, empty running), price opacity and counterparty risk, since freight was paid late or not at all.

Platform models. Digital platforms have replaced parts of this chain in three main forms.

1. **Information-matching platforms (FTA's core).** Shippers post loads and truckers bid or accept. The platform charges membership or listing fees and/or a commission on the trip, but the contract is between shipper and trucker. Practitioner write-ups of FTA's FTL flow describe the steps: the driver pays a deposit (订金) to lock in the order after agreeing load details, the platform charges a technical service fee equal to freight × commission rate, and freight is released to the driver after the consignee signs (practitioner source, secondary) [63].
2. **Online freight carrier platforms (网络货运, formerly "non-vessel/non-truck carriers").** The platform contracts as carrier of record with the shipper, issues the VAT invoice, and subcontracts to individual drivers. Revenue is gross freight and margins are thin. Logory reported a 9.4% gross margin in 2025 [20]. FTA's freight brokerage is this model.
3. **Asset-heavy networks**, for LTL and express-LTL. These are companies such as SF Freight, Anneng, Kuayue and Deppon (both now JD) that operate hubs and line-haul themselves and sell priced services per kilogram or per shipment [64].

Intra-city platforms (Huolala, Didi's freight service, GOGOX) run a closed-loop version of model 1 for vans and light trucks. The platform sets the price and takes a commission of roughly 9–12% [65][66].

Why invoicing drives platform structure. Shippers registered as general VAT taxpayers want a 9% special VAT invoice for transport so they can deduct the input tax. Individual drivers are usually small-scale taxpayers who can issue only a 3% invoice, if they invoice at all (financial press, secondary) [67]. A carrier platform that issues the 9% invoice owes VAT on the full freight value. Its main cost, payments to individual drivers whose fuel, tolls and labour often carry no deductible invoices, provides little input credit. Logory calls this a structural "double tax burden." Commentary on FTA dating back to 2022 noted that this input gap was "mainly covered by government tax rebates," which made brokerage margins depend on rebate levels (secondary) [68]. Local governments have historically returned part of the tax to platforms registered in their jurisdiction ("excess tax burden subsidies"). Logory describes these as a transitional measure whose implementation "has been affected" since mid-2025, because no national tax regime for the model has been issued and local governments have "managed platform business volumes cautiously" [20]. CFLP's platform monitoring found that in 2025 about 30% of online freight platforms suspended business, operating platforms' revenue generally fell 30–40%, and some platforms' effective VAT burden rose to 7–9% (trade press, secondary) [69]. The number of licensed online freight platforms fell to 3,192 at end-2025, the first decline since 2020 (industry data cited in Logory's results) [20].

Pricing and contracts. Owner-operator FTL is priced mostly on the spot market, lane by lane. CFLP tracks it monthly through the China Road Logistics Freight Rate Index, with FTL and LTL sub-indices [70]. No official split of spot and contract freight exists. Fuel (roughly 30–50% of a trucker's operating cost) and tolls (roughly 15–30%) dominate the cost side (trade press, secondary) [43]. Payment terms favour the shipper. Deposits, freight-payment guarantees and dispute handling are therefore real product features for platforms, not just conveniences.

Empty running. No official national empty-running rate is published. CFLP's 2025 driver survey reported that 55.1% of individual operators wait more than five hours for loads. It also cited a fall in the "three-empties" rate (empty running, empty loading, idle time) on FTA's platform from 38% to 34% (association survey) [47]. Competitor Fuyou claims to have cut empty running from an "industry average of 45%" to 6.3% (company claim) [71].

Demand Drivers and Cyclicality

Road freight volume follows industrial production, construction and consumption. CFLP's commentary on August 2026 freight rates illustrates the split. Heavy-goods transport demand weakened as construction slowed, while consumer-related transport rose on summer consumption and trade-in subsidies. Capacity "remains high, so supply exceeds demand," and fuel cost increases "are not fully passed on to rates" [40]. CFLP's 2026 capacity report describes national freight capacity as "saturated at a high level" [72]. Structurally, then, the market has more trucks than loads, which keeps spot rates subdued and puts pressure on driver incomes. In CFLP's 2025 survey, 94% of individual drivers said rates were low and 79.5% reported lower income in 2024 (secondary) [43].

Seasonality. Q1 is the weak quarter because of Chinese New Year. Factories close, drivers go home, and volume dips before recovering in March. FTA's own order series shows this every year: fulfilled orders fell sequentially in Q1 2024, Q1 2025 and Q1 2026 [73][37][23]. Q3 and Q4 are the strongest.

The recent cycle.

Year	Road freight volume YoY	Freight rate index (CFLP)	Heavy-truck sales	Context
2022	-5.5%	—	H1 sales down ~63% a month YoY	COVID controls, lockdowns
2023	+8.7%	102.5 (Jul), "low-level fluctuations"	Recovery	Reopening rebound
2024	+3.8%	105.9 (Dec; FTL 106.3), year high; "supply exceeds demand"	~902k (-1%)	Property slump; weak heavy goods
2025	+3.4%	105.0 (May;	~1.14m (+26–	Scrappage

Year	Road freight volume YoY	Freight rate index (CFLP)	Heavy-truck sales	Context
		+2.0% YoY)	27%), incl. record ~330k exports; NEV >28%	subsidies; NEV switch
2026 YTD	+3.2–3.4% (H1)	105.0 (Aug; -0.1% YoY)	Sep 2026 total -21% YoY; NEV penetration 38.1% YTD, 50.3% in Sep	Construction slowdown; diesel spike Mar–May

Sources: [52][53][54][44][56][70][74][40][75][76][77]; Jul 2023 rate index from CFLP via trade press (secondary) [78]. Truck sales are industry/secondary data. Diesel commentary from FTA's Q2 2026 call (secondary) [2].

Platform volume has been far less cyclical than national volume, because online share gains dominated. FTA's orders grew 24.1% in 2024 and 19.8% in 2025 while road freight volume grew 3.8% and 3.4% [4][54][44]. In Q1 2024 management cited industry growth of about 5% against its own order growth of nearly 30% (third-party transcript, secondary) [79]. Platform pricing is more cyclical. In a weak freight market, shippers have the upper hand and order prices fall, which compresses commissions charged as a percentage of freight. FTA lists exposure to China's road transport market cycle as a risk factor for this reason [1].

Regulatory environment.

Regime / event	Regulator	Date	What it does
Interim Measures for online platform road freight operations	MOT, STA	Effective 2020-01-01 (extended); revised draft Nov 2025	Licensed "online freight" carriers; did not separate matching from carrier platforms
Measures for the Administration of Online Freight Carrier Platforms (交运规〔2026〕1号)	MOT, STA	2026-01-23 (permanent)	Governs carrier platforms only (matching-only platforms "regulated separately"); vehicle/driver verification; ban on fabricated transactions and "yin-yang" settlement; no "unreasonable fees"

Regime / event	Regulator	Date	What it does
			via data, algorithms or platform rules; lawful input-VAT deduction; waybill data shared with tax authorities
Cybersecurity review of Yunmanman and Huochebang	CAC Cybersecurity Review Office	2021-07-05 to 2022-06-29	New user registration suspended for about a year
Summons of freight platforms	MOT-led joint meeting on new transport formats	2021-05-14; 2022-01-20	Monopolising freight information, depressing rates, raising membership fees, altering pricing rules
Industry self-discipline pact	China Road Transport Association	2025-07	FTA, Huolala, Didi, Kuaigou commit to commission transparency, public pricing rules, lower fees, blocking below-cost rates
Anti-monopoly summons of Huolala	SAMR	2025-09-23; rectification 2026-06-18	Algorithms pushing down rates; exclusive stickers; fee rate cut toward ~9%
Regulations on Fair Competition Review	State Council	Effective 2024-08-01	Selective local subsidies without legal basis may be suspended (affects VAT-linked grants)
Decree 810 on platform tax-information reporting	State Council / STA	2025-06-20	Quarterly reporting of platform workers' identity and income from Oct 2025
Fully digitalised e-invoices	STA	2024-12-01	Nationwide e-invoicing ("Golden Tax IV" data-driven administration)
Occupational-injury protection pilot	MOHRSS + 8 ministries	Expanded July 2025; nationwide 2026	Platforms fund injury cover for drivers (~RMB0.18

Regime / event	Regulator	Date	What it does
			per intra-city order, provisional)
Autonomous vehicle transport safety guideline (trial)	MOT	2023-12-05	Permits autonomous vehicles in freight under conditions (safety officer requirements)
Loan-rate guidance	PBOC, NFRA	2025	May cap loan interest rates (affects platform lending)
Regulations on Road Transportation (amended)	State Council	Latest amendment effective 2026-03-20	Licensing of freight operators, vehicles and drivers
Specifications for road freight service on online platforms	MOT	2024-04-02	Platform functions, verification, service procedures, safety, cybersecurity; also a reference for information-matching platforms
Interim Measures for the Supervision of Small Loan Companies	NAFR	2024-12-31	Caps online small-loan balances (e.g. RMB200k per household for consumption)
Implementing Measures of the Fair Competition Review Regulation	SAMR	Effective 2025-04-20	Operationalises review of selective local subsidies
Revised Anti-Unfair Competition Law	NPC Standing Committee	Promulgated 2025-06-27	Tightens platform conduct rules

Sources: [80][21][69][81][1][25][26][43][82][83][66][84][85][67][86]. The last five rows are as summarised in FTA's 20-F regulatory section [1]. The autonomous-guideline details come from a press report whose text was partly garbled; check against the MOT original.

Key Industry Trends and Developments

1. The tax and licensing reset for carrier platforms. The biggest structural change in 2025–2026 is the end of the local-subsidy model that made VAT-invoicing brokerage viable. With grants disrupted from mid-2025 and permanent carrier-platform rules issued in January 2026, carrier platforms must deduct input tax "lawfully" and feed waybills to tax authorities [20][21]. The 2026 rules also formally separate carrier platforms from information-matching platforms, which will get their own rules [21]. The effects are already visible. About 30% of online freight

platforms suspended business in 2025 [69]. Logory's revenue fell 39.9% in 2025 [20]. FTA raised brokerage fees and shrank that business [11]. Top online freight platforms handled 64.1% of waybills and 54.8% of freight value at end-2025 (industry data cited by Logory) [20].

2. Fee scrutiny and "anti-involution." FTA's 20-F says it has attended regulatory guidance meetings, alone and with peers. There regulators stressed setting appropriate prices, charges and refund policies, avoiding unfair competition, transparency, and protecting trucker rights. The filing also says MOT guidance since 2021 has "repeatedly mentioned" ensuring truck drivers' reasonable income and restricting transaction service and membership fees, though no detailed rules have been issued [1]. Regulators have repeatedly targeted platform fees and low-price competition. Freight platforms, FTA included, were summoned in 2021 and 2022 [25][26]. They signed a commission-transparency pact in July 2025 [43]. In September 2025 SAMR's anti-monopoly summons of Huolala cited algorithms that "unreasonably" pushed down rates and set off "involution" [82]. Huolala then cut its fee rate from about 11% to about 9%, refunded RMB120 million of "unreasonable fees" and dropped exclusive-sticker requirements [66]. The 2026 carrier-platform rules prohibit "unreasonable fees" charged via data or algorithms [21]. The sources reviewed found no formal national cap on freight-platform commissions [43].

3. Digitalisation and AI dispatch. Driver adoption of platforms is already high (57% of owner-operators find cargo via apps), and platform matching cuts waiting time and transaction costs [47][61]. A survey cited by People's Daily put the reductions at 1–3 days down to 6–8 hours of waiting, and 6–8% of transaction costs [61]. The next phase is AI agents that post, negotiate, price, track and handle exceptions. FTA, Fuyou and G7 all claim AI dispatch capabilities [16][71][87]. CFLP describes capacity organisation moving toward "platform-based, digital and intelligent" models [72].

4. Electrification of heavy trucks. New-energy heavy trucks went from niche to mainstream in two years: more than 28% of 2025 heavy-truck sales (231,100 units, +182%), 38.1% of January–September 2026 sales, and 50.3% in September 2026 [76][77]. NEV operating costs per km are 25–60% lower for most adopters in CFLP's survey sample [72]. For platforms, electrification changes route economics (charging, range) and is shifting short- and medium-haul work toward EVs. On FTA, EVs account for more than 20% of orders (secondary) [2]. Because NEVs are still only about 3% of the operating stock, the effect on long-haul FTL is gradual [55].

5. Autonomous trucking. Several Chinese companies run commercial or pilot autonomous freight operations with safety officers on board. Inceptio claims more than 1 billion km of commercial autonomous mileage and works with SF Express and JD Logistics (company claim) [88]. KargoBot reports more than 20 million km of L4 platooning (company claim) [89]. Pony.ai holds cross-provincial expressway testing permits, and Zhijia (Plus China, now FTA's Giga.AI) holds China's first licence to test heavy autonomous trucks on open roads [90]. The MOT's 2023 trial guideline provides the regulatory basis [86]. Over the long run, autonomy changes who supplies capacity: fleets of automated trucks rather than individual drivers. That is a structural question for any platform built on owner-operators.

6. Consolidation of networks and logistics-cost policy. In LTL, the express-LTL segment (about RMB184 billion, +8% in 2025) is consolidating around SF Freight (17.5% share of top-10 volume), JD (which fully privatised Deppon in 2026 after buying Kuayue in 2020), Anneng and

Kuayue. The broader large-ticket and regional LTL market (about RMB1.2 trillion) shrank (consultancy estimates, secondary) [64][91]. Government policy favours larger, professional carriers, differentiated highway tolls (such as Henan's truck toll discounts of 15–30% on selected segments) and a higher rail share [48][92].

7. Driver welfare as a policy constraint. New rules on occupational-injury insurance for platform drivers, on-time payment and rest protection, along with CFLP and university surveys documenting long hours and falling incomes, keep platform fees under political scrutiny [43] [47]. The Renmin University survey put average monthly net income at RMB10,512 in 2025, with 3.5 rest days a month (secondary) [43].

3.2 Industry Competitive Dynamics

Competitive Landscape

Digital road freight in China divides into segments that overlap at the edges but have different leaders.

Company	Segment / positioning	Scale (latest disclosed)	Notes
Full Truck Alliance (Yunmanman, Huochebang)	Intercity FTL/LTL information matching; online freight carrier (brokerage)	FY2025 revenue RMB12.49bn; 236.3m fulfilled orders; 3.14m avg shipper MAUs; 4.78m truckers (TTM, Jun 2026)	Largest intercity matching platform; asset-light
Lalamove / Huolala (Lalatech)	Intra-city van and truck, closed-loop pricing; expanding intercity; overseas	2025 global GTV US$13.32bn (+19.6%); revenue US$2.14bn; profit US$447m; 1.03bn orders; 2.10m monthly active drivers	F&S: 61.0% of mainland closed-loop freight GTV (2025); HK IPO application filed Apr 2026, not listed as of latest source
Didi Freight (滴滴送货)	Intra-city freight inside the Didi app	Launched Jun 2020; no standalone metrics published	Summoned with FTA in 2022; signed 2025 pact
GOGOX / Kuaigou Dache (2246.HK)	Intra-city freight and enterprise logistics; mainly HK and overseas	FY2025 revenue RMB671m; net loss RMB163m; 80% of revenue from HK and overseas	Sub-scale on the mainland
Logory / Luge (2482.HK)	Online freight carrier platform for enterprise shippers;	FY2025 revenue RMB4.53bn (-39.9%); online GTV	Shipper-pays, no driver fees; hit by the tax reset

Company	Segment / positioning	Scale (latest disclosed)	Notes
	trucker community app	~RMB29.8bn; 390.5k active drivers; gross margin ~9.4%	
Fuyou Truck (福佑卡车)	Digital FTL brokerage/fulfilment for enterprise shippers	>1.6m carrier drivers; 337 cities (company claim)	Private; revenue not disclosed
G7 E-Fu (G7 易流)	Truck IoT/telematics SaaS, fleet management, energy, digital freight	Serves >3m trucks (company measure); ~US$2.2bn valuation (2022)	Private
Other licensed online freight carriers (e.g., 中储智运, 成丰货运)	Bulk and enterprise carrier platforms	No reliable metrics found	About 3,192 licensed platforms in total (end-2025)
JD Logistics (Deppon, Kuayue), SF Freight, Anneng, ZTO Freight	Asset-heavy LTL and express-LTL networks	SF Freight 2025 revenue RMB46.7bn; Anneng >RMB12bn	Compete for LTL loads; also large buyers of FTL capacity
Offline brokers and information departments	Traditional matching at freight parks	Not measured	Still the incumbent for most freight value

Sources: [4][5][58][93][94][95][26][43][96][20][71][87][60][64]. Competitor figures come from their own filings where available (Logory, GOGOX) and otherwise from press or prospectus summaries (secondary).

Market shares. No reliable, independent market-share data exist for intercity digital freight matching, and the figures below measure different things.

- **FTA.** CIC, writing for FTA's prospectus, called FTA the world's largest digital freight platform by GTV (RMB173.8 billion in 2020) and estimated that about 20% of China's 13.7 million heavy- and medium-duty truckers fulfilled orders on it in 2020 [57][17]. After the 2017 merger, then-chairman Wang Gang claimed about 90% of the truck-matching app market (press interview, secondary) [62]. A vendor compilation put FTA at about 5% of online freight revenue, with online-freight CR10 at about 30%. That basis appears to be licensed carrier-platform revenue, where FTA's brokerage is only one of thousands of participants, so it does not measure matching share (vendor estimate, secondary) [60].
- **Huolala.** Frost & Sullivan puts Huolala at 61.0% of mainland China closed-loop freight GTV and 53.1% globally in 2025. That share is of a market defined as platforms that set the price and settle the payment, which is mainly intra-city (vendor/prospectus) [58].
- **Scale proxies.** FTA's 236 million fulfilled orders in 2025, against the MOT's count of 130 million waybills across all licensed online freight carrier platforms in 2023, gives a sense

of relative scale. The two are not like-for-like: FTA's orders include matching-only trips, while the MOT count covers carrier-platform waybills only [4][59].

In short, FTA is the clear leader in intercity owner-operator matching, Huolala is the clear leader in intra-city, and the carrier-platform (invoicing) segment is fragmented and shrinking. No source provides a dated, audited share of the intercity matching market.

FTA's own description of its competition, in the 20-F, is that no other participant "with a meaningful scale in China has applied a similar marketplace model". It says it competes with regional players in local markets, with players focused on particular segments that may move into its own, and with providers of value-added services. It also names large technology companies with the resources to build digital freight platforms as a potential threat [1].

Level of Competitive Intensity

Intercity FTL matching: moderate and falling, with FTA dominant. The decisive fact is liquidity. A trucker looking for a backhaul from an unfamiliar city goes to the app with the most loads there, and a shipper goes to the app with the most trucks. After the 2017 merger of the two largest apps ended a subsidy war, no national challenger reached comparable two-sided scale in long-haul. Didi and Huolala have concentrated on intra-city, and enterprise-focused players (Fuyou, Logory, G7) serve a different customer with a different model [17][71][20]. Evidence of FTA's pricing room: commission penetration rose from about 70% to about 95% between 2023 and 2026 while trucker retention stayed above 85% [18][5]. The constraint on FTA in this segment is less a competitor than the regulator and the offline alternative. Truckers and shippers can, and do, still find each other through brokers, WeChat groups and freight parks.

Intra-city: high. Huolala, Didi, GOGOX and others compete on price and driver incentives. That competition triggered SAMR's 2025 anti-monopoly summons over "involution", and the 2026 rectification cut Huolala's fee rate [82][66]. Here competition hurts driver earnings, which is exactly what regulators are watching.

Online freight carrier platforms (invoicing): high, then collapsing. Thousands of licensed carriers competed on rebate-subsidised pricing. With subsidies disrupted and tax enforcement data-linked, the segment is shrinking and consolidating [69][20]. Competition here was mainly over who could offer the cheapest invoice. That basis of competition is disappearing.

LTL networks: high, consolidating. The large-ticket LTL market contracted in 2025. Scale players (SF Freight, JD/Deppon/Kuayue, Anneng) are taking share from regional dedicated-line carriers [64]. FTA participates in LTL by matching dedicated-line carriers rather than running a network [30].

Barriers to entry versus barriers to scale. Building a freight app is easy. Building liquidity across hundreds of thousands of lanes is hard, and so is building the trust infrastructure behind it: verification, credit histories, payment protection, dispute handling. FTA's management makes this argument against AI-native entrants [3]. Regulation adds further barriers. Licences are needed for carrier operations, data-security compliance is mandatory (the 2021 CAC review froze FTA's user growth for a year), and since 2026 tax-data integration is required [1][21].

How intensity varies with the cycle. In a soft freight market there is too much capacity, rates fall, and drivers resist platform fees. Regulators then tend to step in on drivers' behalf, as in 2021–2022 and again in 2025–2026. In a tight market shippers compete for trucks, and the platform's matching becomes more valuable.

Basis of Competition

Dimension	What it means in this industry	Who it favours
Liquidity (loads and trucks per lane)	Probability and speed of a match, backhaul availability; drives fulfillment rate and matching time	The scale leader in each segment (FTA intercity; Huolala intra-city)
Price to the trucker (fees)	Commission rates, membership costs, deposits; politically sensitive	Platforms with enough liquidity to charge; constrained by regulators
Price to the shipper	Freight cost versus offline brokers (FTA claims 10–15% savings); posting and membership fees	Platforms that disintermediate brokers
Trust and safety	Verification ("car-certificate-person" match), credit scoring, payment protection, dispute handling, fraud control	Scale players with data and operating teams; now partly mandated by the 2026 rules
Invoicing and tax compliance	Ability to issue 9% VAT invoices lawfully and economically	Formerly rebate-advantaged carriers; now those with compliant input-tax chains or partner models
Technology and AI	Pricing models, matching algorithms, AI posting and negotiation agents, telematics	Data-rich incumbents; telematics players (G7) on the fleet side
Service breadth	Credit, fuel, ETC, insurance, LTL, cold chain, managed shipping	Platforms with large trucker bases to cross-sell
Network operations (LTL)	Hubs, line-haul density, time-definite delivery	Asset-heavy networks (SF Freight, JD/Deppon, Anneng)
Regulatory execution	Licences, data security, fee transparency, driver welfare	Large, compliant incumbents; small platforms exit

Sources: [5][3][21][47][87][64].

Structural Dynamics and Outlook

Four forces will shape the industry over the next several years, based on the sources reviewed.

Scale advantages compounding in matching. Freight matching shows strong local network effects. FTA's fulfillment rate rose from about 30% (2023) to 47% (Q2 2026) and median matching time fell from 14 minutes to about five [8][6][2]. That suggests liquidity still improves with scale even for the leader. Fragmentation on both sides, with millions of SME shippers and millions of owner-operators, makes it hard for asset-heavy or enterprise-focused models to serve the long tail economically. CIC drew this contrast with the US, where shippers are concentrated and served by scaled incumbents [57]. The 2023 collapse of Convoy, a venture-backed US digital broker, after a freight recession and capital-market contraction, shows that digital brokerage taking principal risk in a concentrated market works differently from asset-light matching in a fragmented one [97].

Regulation shifting from growth to conduct and tax. The 2026 carrier-platform rules, the pending rules for matching-only platforms, data-linked tax supervision, fee transparency commitments and SAMR's anti-involution enforcement all move the regulatory agenda toward how platforms make money. Fee levels, algorithmic pricing and driver earnings are now explicit policy objects [21][82][43]. The pending matching-platform rules (Article 31 of the 2026 Measures) bear most directly on FTA's core model and had not been issued in the sources reviewed [21].

Disruption risks. These are AI agents that could lower the cost of matching outside platforms, autonomous trucks that would replace owner-operators with fleets, electrification that changes route economics, and the eventual rationalisation of the owner-operator base that the government's cost-reduction plan explicitly seeks [48][88][77].

Contested segments. These include intra-city (Huolala versus Didi and others), managed or "entrusted" shipping for enterprises (FTA, Fuyou, carrier platforms), LTL (networks versus matching platforms connecting dedicated-line carriers), and invoicing (now moving to compliant aggregator models). Overseas, emerging-market road freight is the next frontier for both Lalamove, which is already international, and FTA's QMove [58][3].

Summary. China's road freight market is large (on the order of RMB5–6 trillion for intercity freight), grows at low single digits, and remains highly fragmented on both sides. Platforms have captured most drivers' attention but still a minority of freight value. Intercity matching has consolidated into one dominant platform, intra-city into one leader with active challengers, and the invoicing (carrier-platform) segment is being reset by tax enforcement. The main open variables are regulatory: how fees and algorithmic pricing will be supervised, and how matching-only platforms will be regulated.

4. Financial Overview

Definitions used in this part.

- **Fiscal year:** calendar year. FY2025 = year ended December 31, 2025. All amounts are in RMB millions unless stated. One ADS = 20 Class A ordinary shares [1].

- **Revenue excluding brokerage:** total net revenues minus freight brokerage revenue. Management has guided on this basis since Q3 2025 [14].
- **Tax-related costs net of grants:** VAT, surcharges and other taxes, net of local-government grants, recorded in cost of revenues; mostly attributable to freight brokerage [4].
- **Non-GAAP adjusted operating income / net income:** GAAP figures excluding share-based compensation (SBC), amortisation of acquired intangibles, compensation tied to acquisitions, impairments of long-term investments, the 2023 class-action settlement provision, and related tax effects [4][1].
- **Free cash flow (FCF):** net cash from operating activities minus capital expenditure (company definition, first presented in the FY2025 release). Operating cash flow includes the change in loans receivable from the credit business [4][1].
- **Cash position:** cash and cash equivalents, restricted cash, short-term investments, long-term time deposits and wealth-management products maturing after one year [6].
- **Penetration and monetisation per order** are defined in Part 1. Figures for Q4 2025 onward come from call Q&A in third-party transcripts (secondary).
- **"(c)"** marks a figure computed by us from reported numbers.

4.1 KPI Trends

Top-line KPIs

Annual revenue by line.

RMB m	FY2023 (recast)	FY2024	YoY	FY2025	YoY
Freight brokerage	3,916.4	4,727.0	+20.7%	4,199.4	-11.2%
Freight listing	828.2	879.5	+6.2%	980.2	+11.4%
Transaction service	2,309.0	3,848.7	+66.7%	5,317.2	+38.2%
Value-added services	1,382.6	1,783.5	+29.0%	1,993.1	+11.8%
Total net revenues	**8,436.2**	**11,238.6**	**+33.2%**	**12,489.9**	**+11.1%**
Revenue excl. brokerage (c)	4,519.8	6,511.6	+44.1%	8,290.5	+27.3%
VAT included in net revenues	4,173	5,098	—	4,671	—

Sources: [12][4][1]. FY2023 is on the basis recast for the January 2024 reclassification of intra-city revenue into transaction service. FY2022 revenue was RMB6,733.6m on the original basis [35].

Quarterly revenue by line (RMB m, YoY in brackets).

Quarter	Total	Brokerage	Listing	Transaction service	Value-added	Excl. brokerage (c)
Q3 2024	3,031.4 (+33.9%)	1,280.9 (+19.7%)	223.4 (+4.9%)	1,047.5 (+68.6%)	479.6 (+33.4%)	1,750.5 (+46.6%)
Q4 2024	3,174.3 (+31.8%)	1,316.1 (+17.0%)	230.5 (+7.5%)	1,158.3 (+71.1%)	469.3 (+19.8%)	1,858.2 (+44.8%)
Q1 2025	2,699.9 (+19.0%)	965.7 (+0.1%)	234.9 (+10.0%)	1,046.5 (+51.5%)	452.8 (+13.5%)	1,734.2 (+33.0%)
Q2 2025	3,239.1 (+17.2%)	1,177.9 (+1.1%)	242.9 (+14.5%)	1,327.1 (+39.4%)	491.2 (+12.8%)	2,061.2 (+28.9%)
Q3 2025	3,358.2 (+10.8%)	1,094.3 (-14.6%)	247.1 (+10.6%)	1,456.1 (+39.0%)	560.7 (+16.9%)	2,263.9 (+29.3%)
Q4 2025	3,192.6	961.5 (-26.9%)	255.2 (+10.7%)	1,487.5	488.4 (+4.1%)	2,231.1

Quarter	Total	Brokerage	Listing	Transaction service	Value-added	Excl. brokerage (c)
	(+0.6%)			(+28.4%)		(+20.1%)
Q1 2026	2,848.4 (+5.5%)	827.1 (-14.4%)	252.2 (+7.4%)	1,393.1 (+33.1%)	376.0 (-17.0%)	2,021.3 (+16.6%)
Q2 2026	3,381.6 (+4.4%)	995.4 (-15.5%)	250.8 (+3.3%)	1,766.4 (+33.1%)	369.0 (-24.9%)	2,386.2 (+15.8%)

Sources: quarterly releases [98][12][37][14][13][4][23][6]. Q4 figures are derived from full-year releases; some YoY rates computed.

Reported revenue growth fell from more than 30% in 2024 to low single digits in Q4 2025–Q2 2026. That slowdown is mostly the planned shrinkage of brokerage, which carries a VAT gross-up and earns little gross profit. Revenue excluding brokerage slowed more gently, from about +45% in 2H24 to about +16% in 1H26. Within it, transaction service has held steady at +33% for two quarters. The decline in value-added services is the deliberate run-off of the credit book (Part 1) [6]. The company gives no price/volume/FX split; there is no FX effect on revenue because revenue is all in RMB. For the transaction-service line, however, a volume × penetration × price decomposition can be built from the operating disclosures.

Transaction-service decomposition.

Quarter	Fulfilled orders (m)	YoY	Commission penetration	Monetisation per order (RMB)	Transaction service (RMB m)	YoY
Q1 2024	39.3	+29.6%	77.4%	22.7	691.0	+61.5%
Q2 2024	49.1	+22.0%	81.1%	23.9	951.9	+63.4%
Q3 2024	51.9	+22.1%	82.8%	24.4	1,047.5	+68.6%
Q4 2024	56.9	+24.3%	82.9%	24.6	1,158.3	+71.1%
Q1 2025	48.2	+22.6%	85.2%	25.5	1,046.5	+51.5%
Q2 2025	60.8	+23.8%	86.7%	25.2	1,327.1	+39.4%
Q3 2025	63.4	+22.3%	88.6%	25.9	1,456.1	+39.0%
Q4 2025	63.9	+12.3%	88.6%	26.3	1,487.5	+28.4%
Q1 2026	55.0	+14.3%	>94%	~26.9	1,393.1	+33.1%
Q2 2026	68.5	+12.7%	94.7%	n/d (~27, implied c)	1,766.4	+33.1%

Sources: orders and revenue from releases [73][41][98][12][37][14][13][4][23][6]; penetration and monetisation from prepared remarks [18][24][32][39][19][15][9] and call Q&A (secondary) [3] [16][2]. n/d = not disclosed.

The three drivers multiply out to the reported growth. For Q4 2025: orders +12.3%, penetration +6.9% (82.9% to 88.6%) and monetisation +6.9% (RMB24.6 to 26.3) compound to +28.3%, against +28.4% reported (c). For Q1 2026: +14.3% × about +10.6% × +5.5% ≈ +33%, against +33.1% reported (c). Q2 2026 follows the same logic. Orders contributed about 13 points, penetration about 9 points, and an implied rise in per-order monetisation of roughly 8% (to about RMB27) supplied the remainder (c). The line also contains trucker memberships and intra-city revenue, so the identity is approximate. Two of the three drivers are slowing. Order growth halved in Q4 2025, which management attributes to governance (Part 1), and penetration has reached about 95%, so it cannot add much more. Future growth in this line depends more heavily on orders and per-order monetisation, as management acknowledged in Q2 2026 (secondary) [2].

Segment and Product KPIs

Platform activity.

Quarter	Shipper MAUs (m)	YoY	Fulfillment rate	Direct shippers' share of orders	Active truckers, TTM (m)
Q3 2024	2.84	+33.6%	34.5%	49%	>4.0
Q4 2024	2.93	+31.3%	37.5%	50%	4.14
Q1 2025	2.76	+28.8%	39.2%	51%	4.18
Q2 2025	3.16	+19.3%	40.7%	53%	4.34
Q3 2025	3.35	+17.6%	40.6%	54%	4.48
Q4 2025	3.28	+11.6%	42.7%	55%	n/d
Q1 2026	3.11	+12.7%	44.1%	n/d	n/d
Q2 2026	3.57	+12.8%	47.0%	n/d	4.78

Sources: MAUs from releases [98][12][37][14][13][4][23][6]; fulfillment rate, direct-shipper share and active truckers from prepared remarks and presentations [32][39][19][15][9][5]; Q4 2025–Q1 2026 fulfillment rate and direct-shipper share from call Q&A (secondary) [3][16].

Shipper growth slowed from about 30% to about 12% between 2024 and 2026. Fulfillment rate rose about 6 points a year throughout. More orders are being completed per shipper, and orders grew about as fast as MAUs (+12.7% versus +12.8% in Q2 2026). The governance campaign in Q4 2025 removed accounts and low-quality orders, which flatters the fulfillment rate and penetration while depressing order and MAU growth (secondary) [3].

Brokerage KPIs.

Quarter	Brokerage revenue	YoY	VAT included in total revenue	Tax-related costs net of grants (in COR)
Q1 2025	965.7	+0.1%	1,064.9	565.6
Q2 2025	1,177.9	+1.1%	1,294.9	1,087.1
Q3 2025	1,094.3	-14.6%	1,222.9	1,427.2
Q4 2025	961.5	-26.9%	1,088.6	864.9
Q1 2026	827.1	-14.4%	941.6	614.3
Q2 2026	995.4	-15.5%	1,109.2	743.4
FY2024	4,727.0	+20.7%	5,097.7	4,584.4
FY2025	4,199.4	-11.2%	4,671.4	3,944.7

Sources: [37][14][13][4][23][6][1]; Q1–Q3 2025 tax-related costs from prepared remarks [19][15][9].

Net tax cost swings much more from quarter to quarter than brokerage revenue does: RMB566 million in Q1 2025, RMB1,427 million in Q3 2025. The reason is that grants are recognised when received, or when conditions are met and receipt is probable [1]. The timing of local-government payments therefore drives quarterly gross margin. Q1 2025 cost of revenues fell 32% partly because brokerage was "proactively downsized … in anticipation of possible VAT

rebate adjustments" [19]. Q3 2025 absorbed the fee-change transition and low grant receipts. The 20-F gives annual figures: gross VAT on brokerage of RMB5,996.2 million (2024) and RMB4,165.7 million (2025), offset by grants of RMB2,102.8 million and RMB903.3 million [1]. Brokerage-specific gross VAT was RMB5,006.4 million (2023), RMB5,608.2 million (2024) and RMB3,666.6 million (2025). Against brokerage revenue of RMB3,916.4 million, RMB4,727.0 million and RMB4,199.4 million, that VAT exceeded revenue in 2023 and 2024 but not in 2025, after the fee increase [1]. Surcharges and other taxes (RMB855.0 million in 2025) and total grants (RMB1,076.0 million) are "substantially all" brokerage-related [1]. On those figures, brokerage's gross profit before any other cost was roughly RMB0.53 billion in 2024 and RMB0.75 billion in 2025 (c).

Credit solutions KPIs.

Date	Loans receivable, net (on-B/S, RMB m)	Total outstanding incl. off-B/S (RMB bn)	NPL ratio (new basis)	NPL ratio (old basis)	Provision in quarter (RMB m)
Dec 2023	3,521.1	—	—	2.0%	—
Dec 2024	4,199.6	4.4	2.0%	2.2%	73.9 (Q4)
Jun 2025	4,861.8	—	—	2.1%	75.0 (Q2)
Sep 2025	4,996.2	—	—	2.2%	144.4 (Q3)
Dec 2025	4,851.4	5.5	2.9%	—	144.0 (Q4)
Mar 2026	n/d	5.2	3.2%	—	143.6 (Q1)
Jun 2026	3,629.9	4.3	3.8%	—	72.0 (Q2)

Sources: [35][12][14][13][4][23][6][5].

Credit losses rose through 2025. Quarterly provisions roughly doubled from Q3 2025, the allowance rose to 7.2% of gross loans at year-end, and >90-day past-due balances rose to 3.0% of gross [1]. The company attributed this to "industry-wide risk fluctuation" [4]. It capped loan rates at 26% annualised, tightened approvals and began shrinking the own-funded book (secondary) [3]. The 3.8% NPL ratio at June 2026 partly reflects the denominator shrinking (-21.9% in six months) as delinquent balances aged past 90 days [6]. Q2 2026 provisions fell back to RMB72.0 million as the book contracted [6]. Management guided for the NPL ratio to stabilise and begin falling in 2H26 (secondary) [3].

Profitability KPIs

Quarterly margins.

Quarter	Gross margin (c)	Operating margin (c)	Non-GAAP op. margin (c)	Net income (RMB m)	Non-GAAP net income (RMB m)	Non-GAAP net margin (c)
Q3 2024	55.0%	25.1%	29.2%	1,121.9	1,241.2	40.9%
Q4 2024	56.2%	26.3%	30.3%	574.6	1,052.0	33.1%
Q1 2025	74.1%	44.5%	48.8%	1,278.9	1,391.4	51.5%
Q2 2025	61.8%	35.2%	38.0%	1,264.8	1,352.1	41.7%
Q3 2025	52.2%	23.1%	25.3%	921.0	988.1	29.4%
Q4 2025	66.3%	32.2%	34.5%	994.3	1,063.1	33.3%
Q1 2026	72.7%	35.3%	42.8%	994.1	1,202.0	42.2%
Q2 2026	72.6%	43.9%	46.7%	1,345.1	1,433.8	42.4%

Sources: quarterly releases [98][12][37][14][13][4][23][6]. Margins computed.

Annual margins and opex ratios.

% of revenue	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	1H 2026 (c)
Gross margin	51.2%	54.6%	63.0%	72.7%
Sales & marketing	14.7%	14.2%	14.0%	13.4%
General & administrative	11.1%	8.1%	5.7%	7.8%
Research & development	11.2%	7.8%	7.0%	8.3%
Provision for credit solutions	2.8%	2.6%	3.6%	3.5%
Operating margin	11.8%	22.0%	33.2%	40.0%
Non-GAAP operating margin	18.7%	27.0%	36.0%	45.0%
Non-GAAP net margin	33.2%	35.8%	38.4%	42.3%

Sources: [1][12][4][23][6]. All ratios computed.

Margins have moved in steps, and the drivers can be named. **Mix** is the biggest. Brokerage, which carries close to zero gross margin after net VAT, fell from 42% to 29% of revenue while near-100%-margin commissions rose from 34% to 52% [5]. **Operating leverage** came next. G&A fell from 11.1% to 5.7% of revenue between FY2023 and FY2025 on lower SBC and lower salaries, and R&D was held flat in absolute terms until Giga.AI was consolidated [1][39]. **Grant timing** explains the quarter-to-quarter noise: Q1 2025 at 74% gross margin, Q3 2025 at 52%. **Credit provisions** took about 1 point off operating margin in 2H25 [13][4]. Q1 2026 GAAP operating margin was held down by a spike in SBC (RMB190.1 million, of which most fell in G&A) [23].

Non-operating income is large. Interest income on the cash pile was RMB1,141.9 million (2023), RMB1,073.4 million (2024) and RMB954.1 million (2025), equal to 51%, 34% and 21% of net income in those years (c) [1]. The share has fallen as operating income grew, and the 2025 decline itself was “primarily due to” lower yields on the US dollar cash held outside the PRC [1]. “Other income, net” (RMB109.2 million in 2025) is mainly ADR fee income from the depositary bank, Deutsche Bank Trust Company Americas [1]. The effective tax rate rose from 4.6% (2023) and 7.1% (2024) to 17.2% (2025), as pre-tax income rose and the tax-exemption period of the group’s software enterprises expired, and as RMB80 million of withholding tax was accrued on a RMB0.8 billion dividend from PRC subsidiaries to the Hong Kong holding company [1]. GAAP net income grew 42.8% in FY2025 against 67.5% growth in operating income [4].

Working Capital and Balance-Sheet KPIs

FTA runs on negative working capital in its core platform. Shippers prepay memberships (contract liabilities RMB649.8 million at end-2025) and advance freight (advances from shippers and truckers RMB434.5 million), while FTA holds few receivables apart from the loan book and payment-channel balances (RMB120.6 million) [1]. The loan book is the main working-capital variable. Growth in loans receivable consumed RMB1.11 billion of operating cash flow in 2023, RMB0.98 billion in 2024 and RMB1.08 billion in 2025. The 2026 run-off reverses this, and management cited "capital released from the credit business" as a driver of the RMB2.15 billion operating cash flow in Q2 2026 (secondary) [1][2].

Balance-sheet KPI	Dec 2024	Dec 2025	Jun 2026
Cash position (RMB bn)	29.2	31.5	33.4
Cash position / total assets (c)	71%	71%	73%
Loans receivable, net (RMB m)	4,199.6	4,851.4	3,629.9
Goodwill + intangibles (RMB m)	3,518.3	4,782.8	n/d (goodwill 4,025.4)
Total liabilities (RMB m)	3,151.9	3,050.4	3,778.2
Borrowings	nil	nil	nil (short-term debt negligible)
Total equity (RMB m)	37,692.1	40,523.8	40,860.9
Return on average equity, FY (c)	—	11.4% (FY2025)	—

Sources: [1][12][4][6][5]. ROE = net income / average total equity (c). Goodwill rose in 2025 on the Giga.AI acquisition (RMB821.7m goodwill, RMB401.5m intangible) [1].

Return on equity is held down by the cash pile. About 71–73% of assets are cash and investments, which earn interest-income returns, while the platform itself requires very little capital.

4.2 Financial Highlights

Income statement summary (RMB m).

	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	Q2 2025	Q2 2026
Net revenues	8,436.2	11,238.6	12,489.9	3,239.1	3,381.6
Cost of revenues	(4,119.0)	(5,100.6)	(4,618.8)	(1,238.4)	(925.9)
Gross profit (c)	4,317.2	6,138.0	7,871.1	2,000.7	2,455.7
Sales & marketing	(1,239.2)	(1,596.8)	(1,747.8)	(433.8)	(455.4)
General & administrative	(937.7)	(913.8)	(709.8)	(170.3)	(183.8)

	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	Q2 2025	Q2 2026
Research & development	(946.6)	(880.0)	(874.4)	(189.6)	(260.9)
Provision for credit solutions	(234.6)	(296.5)	(445.4)	(75.0)	(72.0)
Other operating income	38.4	24.0	52.5	7.7	2.5
Income from operations	**997.4**	**2,475.0**	**4,146.2**	**1,139.6**	**1,486.1**
Interest income	1,141.9	1,073.4	954.1	251.3	215.4
Impairment of long-term investment	—	(352.7)	—	—	—
Income tax	(106.8)	(239.4)	(929.2)	n/d	n/d
Net income	**2,227.1**	**3,123.4**	**4,459.1**	**1,264.8**	**1,345.1**
Net income attributable to ordinary shareholders	2,212.9	3,069.8	4,408.2	1,244.5	1,330.0
Diluted EPS per ADS (RMB)	2.09	2.94	4.21	1.19	1.28
Non-GAAP adj. operating income	1,580.4	3,032.3	4,499.8	1,230.1	1,580.7
Non-GAAP adj. net income	2,797.0	4,020.4	4,794.7	1,352.1	1,433.8
Non-GAAP diluted EPS per ADS (RMB)	2.63	3.80	4.53	1.27	1.36
Weighted avg diluted ADS (m)	1,058.1	1,045.1	1,046.4	1,046.7	1,041.0

Sources: [1][35][12][4][14][6]. FY2025 US$ translation rate in the 20-F: RMB6.9931 = US$1.00.

GAAP to non-GAAP reconciliation items. The company adjusts for:

1. **Share-based compensation:** RMB441.8m (2023), RMB496.6m (2024), RMB281.6m (2025); RMB261.1m in 1H26 versus RMB180.1m in 1H25.
2. **Amortisation of acquired intangibles:** RMB52.1m (2024), RMB72.0m (2025). This rose from about RMB13m to about RMB23–24m a quarter after Giga.AI was consolidated.
3. **Impairment of a long-term investment:** RMB352.7m in Q4 2024, on an available-for-sale debt investment whose investee could not meet redemption requests.
4. **Settlement of the US securities class action:** a provision in 2023; US$10.25m was paid in 2024.
5. **Acquisition-related compensation**, where applicable.
6. **Tax effects** of the above.

Sources: [1][12][4][6].

The gap between GAAP and non-GAAP net income narrowed from RMB897m in FY2024 to RMB336m in FY2025 (c), as SBC fell and the 2024 impairment did not recur [12][4].

Cash position by quarter-end (RMB bn).

Dec 2023	Dec 2024	Jun 2025	Dec 2025	Mar 2026	Jun 2026
27.6	29.2	29.5	31.5	32.3	33.4 (US$4.9bn)

Sources: [35][12][14][4][23][6].

At June 30, 2026 the components were: cash and cash equivalents RMB6,800.9m, restricted cash RMB279.6m, short-term investments RMB16,753.9m, and long-term time deposits RMB9,586m [6]. Of the end-2025 balance, RMB11.07bn was RMB-denominated [1].

Cash flow (RMB m).

	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	Q3 2025	Q4 2025	Q1 2026	Q2 2026
Operating cash flow	2,269.6	2,970.1	4,626.9	1,657.1	1,330.9	1,562.0	2,150.2
Capex	(100.3)	(75.0)	(129.7)	(48.5)c	(34.5)	(68.2)	(110.3)
Free cash flow	2,169.3c	2,895.2	4,497.2	1,608.6c	1,296.4	1,493.8	2,040.0
FCF / non-GAAP net income (c)	78%	72%	94%	163%	122%	124%	142%
Dividends paid	—	(1,064.2)	(1,425.1)	n/d	n/d	n/d	n/d
Share repurchases (cash)	(1,168.3)	(489.4)	(288.6)	n/d	n/d	n/d	n/d

Sources: [1][13][4][23][6]. Q3 2025 capex derived from FY2025 less the other quarters. Trailing-twelve-month FCF to June 2026 was about RMB6.44bn (c), consistent with the ~RMB6.4bn shown in the Q2 2026 presentation [5].

Three things to understand about these financials.

First, reported revenue understates the growth of the core and overstates the brokerage business. About RMB4.7bn of FY2025 revenue was VAT collected and passed through, mostly on brokerage [1]. Until 2025 brokerage's gross VAT burden exceeded its reported revenue [1]. Its shrinkage cut reported revenue growth from 33% (FY2024) to 11% (FY2025) and to about 5% in 1H26, while non-brokerage revenue grew 27% in FY2025 and about 16% in 1H26 [4][6]. Gross and operating margins rose for the same reason. Mix explains much of the margin expansion, and part of it is a presentation effect of the shrinking VAT gross-up.

Second, the P&L is exposed to local-government grant timing, and exposure falls as brokerage shrinks. Grants fell from RMB2.10bn to RMB0.90bn in 2025. Their timing moved quarterly gross margin by as much as 20 points (74% in Q1 2025, 52% in Q3 2025) [1]. The 2025–2026 shift to higher self-operated fees and the aggregator channel reduces this sensitivity. The company has not quantified grants for 2026.

Third, cash generation is accelerating while the cash pile earns less. FCF exceeded non-GAAP net income in each of the last four quarters. Drivers are the run-off of the loan book, negative working capital and minimal capex [6][2]. Interest income meanwhile fell from RMB1.14bn (2023) to RMB0.95bn (2025) and RMB215m in Q2 2026 [1][6]. Cash is building: RMB33.4bn at June 2026, about 82% of total equity (c). Capital-return policy (next section) therefore governs how much of this the shareholder sees.

4.3 Capital Allocation

Share repurchases.

Year	Shares repurchased	≈ADS (m)	Amount (US$m)	Avg price per ADS (US$, c)	Programme
2023	455.0m Class A	22.75	147.7	6.49	US$500m authorisation (Mar 2023, 12 months)
2024	255.5m Class A	12.77	93.6	7.33	2023 programme (Jan–Mar) then ~US$300m extension to Mar 2025

Year	Shares repurchased	≈ADS (m)	Amount (US$m)	Avg price per ADS (US$, c)	Programme
2025 (open market)	4.4m Class A	0.22 (3,100 in Jul at US$10.94; 217,895 in Aug at US$10.90)	2.4	10.90	US$200m programme to Mar 12, 2026
2025 (private, May 19)	29.5m Class A + 31.2m Class B	3.04	37.5	12.35	One-off purchase from executive officers
2026 (Jan 1–Mar 11)	—	~5.1	~50.0	~9.8	FY2026 return plan; then new US$50m authorisation

Sources: [1][35][36][12][37][4]. ADS conversions and average prices computed. 2025 monthly detail from 20-F Item 16E; about US$197.6m of the US$200m authorisation remained unused at the end of August 2025.

Repurchases have roughly offset dilution from employee equity. Options exercised into Class A shares were 131.9m (2023), 156.8m (2024) and 100.6m (2025) [1]. Weighted diluted ADS fell from 1,058.1m (FY2023) to 1,045.1m (FY2024), was flat in FY2025 (1,046.4m), and was 1,041.0m in Q2 2026 [4][6]. The May 2025 private purchase of 60.7m shares from executive officers was priced at US$12.35 per ADS (the May 16 closing price). It was made outside the buyback programme, so that executives could realise vested awards without selling in the market. Peter Hui Zhang used all of his net proceeds to invest in Giga.AI preferred shares. All 31.2m Class B shares in the purchase came from the founder's vehicle, the only Class B holder [1].

Dividends.

Dividend	Declared	Per ADS (US$)	Total (US$m)	Paid
FY2023 annual (first)	Mar 13, 2024	0.1444	~150	Apr 2024
2025 semi-annual #1	Mar 5, 2025	0.0960	~100	Apr 2025
2025 semi-annual #2	Aug 21, 2025	0.0960	~100	Oct 2025
2026 quarterly #1	Mar 12, 2026	0.0840	~87.5	Apr 2026
2026 quarterly #2	May 21, 2026	0.0840	~87.5	Jul 2026
2026 quarterly #3	Aug 19, 2026	0.0840	~87.5	Oct 28, 2026

Sources: [36][12][14][4][23][6].

Capital expenditure. Capex is small: RMB100.3m (2023), RMB75.0m (2024) and RMB129.7m (2025), 0.7–1.2% of revenue (c). It rose to RMB178.5m in 1H26 [1][23][6]. The main project is a Nanjing headquarters building, estimated at RMB0.8bn in total. RMB248.4m had been paid by

end-2025, with RMB200.1m of contracted commitments remaining and completion expected in 2H27 [1].

Acquisitions and investments.

Deal	Date	Size	What it added
Yunmanman–Huochebang merger	2017	Share merger	Combined the two leading apps
Guiyang Huochebang (restructuring)	Mar 2021	Intra-group	Consolidated operating entity
Yushi Fund LP stake (72.58%, equity method)	2021	RMB323m	Investment vehicle
TYT (Beijing Bang Li De Network Technology)	Dec 2021	Not disclosed	Equipment-transportation services; management NCI shares vest over four years from Jul 2022
PlusAI split into Plus PRC (now Giga.AI) and Plus Automation	Jul 2023	Share exchange	FTA holds 17.2% of Plus Automation (fully diluted; ~US$91.6m cost)
Giga.AI loans and convertible notes	Feb 2024–Jan 2025	US$5m loans (repaid); US$20m + US$16m 12% notes	Bridge funding ahead of control
Giga.AI (formerly Plus PRC): additional investment approved	May 16, 2025	US$125m	Raised stake ahead of control
Giga.AI: control and consolidation	Jul 9, 2025	US$85m cash plus US$40m notes converted; total consideration RMB1,376.3m incl. prior stake	Goodwill RMB821.7m; intangible RMB401.5m; 69.9% equity, 76.1% votes
Giga.AI: further stake from Plus (US)	Sep 2025	US$20m	Stake to 80.8%

Sources: [1][17][37].

Debt and obligations. FTA has no bank borrowings, bonds or credit facilities on its balance sheet and no credit ratings disclosed. Contractual obligations at end-2025 were limited to RMB36.0m of operating leases [1]. Off balance sheet, FTA guarantees partner-funded loans. Guarantee liabilities were immaterial, but the maximum undiscounted payment FTA could be required to make was RMB359.1m at end-2025 [1][22].

Stated framework versus behaviour. The January 19, 2026 Long-Term Shareholder Return Plan commits FTA to distribute at least 50% of the prior fiscal year's non-GAAP adjusted net income each year. For FY2026 that means about US$400m, at least US$300m through quarterly dividends and the rest through open-market buybacks [28]. Applied to FY2025 non-GAAP net income of RMB4,794.7m, the 50% floor is about RMB2.4bn, or roughly US$343m at the 20-F exchange rate. The US$400m target is therefore about 58% of FY2025 non-GAAP net income (c) [4][1]. By August 2026 FTA had declared three quarterly dividends (~US$262.5m) and bought back ~US$50m of stock, about US$312.5m against the US$400m target (c) [4][23][6]. Under the US$50m 2026 authorisation, no buybacks were mentioned on the Q2 2026 call (secondary) [2]. Capital returns have stepped up each year:

- FY2024: about US$244m (US$150m dividend plus US$93.6m buybacks)
- FY2025: about US$239m (US$199m dividends plus about US$40m buybacks)
- FY2026 target: US$400m

(c), from [1][28].

All of these are well below FCF: FY2025 FCF of RMB4.50bn was about US$643m at the 20-F rate (c). Cash therefore keeps accumulating. Management says new initiatives (overseas, autonomous driving) will proceed with "controlled pacing, manageable cash outflows, and measurable milestones" (secondary) [3].

4.4 Long-Term Guidance & Outlook

Current guidance. FTA guides only one quarter ahead, on revenue, and calls the guidance "preliminary and subject to change". There is no annual revenue, margin or earnings guidance [6].

Quarter	Date given	Total revenue guidance (RMB bn)	Excl. brokerage guidance (RMB bn)	Actual total (RMB m)	Actual excl. brokerage (RMB m, c)	Actual vs top of range (c)
Q3 2025	Aug 21, 2025	3.07–3.17	2.16–2.26	3,358.2	2,263.9	+5.9%
Q4 2025	Nov 17, 2025	3.08–3.18	2.18–2.28	3,192.6	2,231.1	+0.4%
Q1 2026	Mar 12, 2026	2.70–2.80	1.98–2.06	2,848.4	2,021.3	+1.7%
Q2 2026	May 21, 2026	3.07–3.17	2.21–2.30	3,381.6	2,386.2	+6.7%
Q3 2026	Aug 19, 2026	3.32–3.42 (-1.1% to +1.8% YoY)	not given	Due Nov 19, 2026	—	—

Sources: [14][13][4][23][6][7]. Actual revenue has been at or above the top of the guided range in each of the last ten quarters (Q1 2024–Q2 2026) (c).

The Q3 2026 range implies flat total revenue year on year. Brokerage is still shrinking against a Q3 2025 base that already included one month of the higher fee. Management gives no explicit assumptions on order growth, penetration or brokerage volume. In qualitative terms, it is "cautiously optimistic" on 2026 order growth and expects the fulfillment rate to keep a "steady upward trajectory" (secondary) [3][2]. Brokerage fee rates are about 10% self-operated and low single digits through aggregators (secondary) [2]. The credit book is expected to shrink further, with the NPL ratio stabilising in 2H26 (secondary) [3].

Long-term algorithm. FTA has not published a long-term financial framework.

Element	Stated target	Date set / reaffirmed
Revenue growth	Not given	—
Transaction commissions	"Grow by 10x" (orders 3x, take rate on high-value orders 2x, penetration 1.5x); no horizon	2023 Investor Day (Sep 19, 2023)
Margins	Not given	—
EPS growth / FCF conversion	Not given	—
Leverage	No debt; no target stated	—
Capital return	≥50% of prior-year non-GAAP adjusted net income annually; US$400m in FY2026 (≥US$300m via quarterly dividends)	Jan 19, 2026; reaffirmed May and Aug 2026

Sources: [8][28][23][6].

Strategic programmes.

- *AI across matching and fulfilment.* Shipper posting agent, matching and fulfilment agents, trucker assistant, AI customer service. 2026 plan: extend the agent framework across shipper, dispatch and service workflows. No spending figure is disclosed [31][16][3].
- *Giga.AI / autonomous trucking.* US$125m investment approved in May 2025. Consolidated from July 2025, adding R&D cost: Q2 2026 R&D was RMB260.9m versus RMB189.6m a year earlier, mainly from Giga.AI. An AI heavy-truck fleet runs in express and fast-freight lanes, and autonomous-delivery pilots are in multiple cities [37][6][29][31].
- *QMove overseas.* Four markets, focused on network density, with no monetisation timeline [30][3].
- *Brokerage restructuring* toward the aggregator channel, and the *credit-business shift* to partner-funded, guarantee-backed lending (secondary) [16][2].

Leadership. No CEO transition has been announced. In 2025 two roles were reorganised. In April, Kai Shen became Chief Public Affairs and Risk Officer, after serving as chief risk officer and general counsel since 2019. In May, Simon Cai moved from CFO (2020–May 2025) to Chief Financing and Investment Officer, and finance, tax and cash planning now sit with President Langbo Guo [1]. In March 2026 the eight directors and officers filed initial Section 16 ownership reports after foreign private issuers' insiders became subject to them [99].

Key Risks to the Outlook

Brokerage tax regime and grants. The 20-F warns that grants underpin brokerage gross profit and rest on non-statutory local agreements that could be suspended under the Fair

Competition Review rules. Grants fell 57% in 2025 [1]. The January 2026 carrier-platform rules link waybills to tax data and require lawful input-VAT deduction [21]. Industry data show about 30% of carrier platforms suspended business in 2025 [69]. FTA's move to the aggregator model reduces but does not remove exposure. Self-operated brokerage at a ~10% take rate remains about 29% of revenue (Q2 2026) [5].

Fee regulation of matching platforms. FTA's main profit line is a percentage commission on truckers' freight. The 2026 rules prohibit "unreasonable fees" via data and algorithms, and a separate regime for matching-only platforms is pending [21]. Huolala's 2025–2026 SAMR rectification cut its fee rate from about 11% to about 9% and refunded "unreasonable fees" [66]. FTA was summoned over membership fees and pricing in 2021 and 2022 and signed the 2025 commission-transparency pact [25][26][43]. The 20-F lists possible limits on transaction and membership fees as a risk [1].

Growth drivers maturing. Commission penetration is at about 95%, so transaction-service growth depends on order growth (about +13%) and per-order monetisation [5][6]. Per-order monetisation is the politically sensitive variable. Shipper MAU growth has slowed from about 30% to about 13%, and part of the 2025–2026 slowdown is attributed to governance actions whose lasting effect cannot be verified from disclosures [6][3].

Credit quality. The NPL ratio rose from 2.0% to 3.8% in eighteen months, with provisions doubling in 2H25 [4][6]. FTA keeps credit risk on partner-funded loans it guarantees [4]. Rate caps (26%) and PBOC/NFRA guidance limit pricing [3][1]. Value-added services revenue is already falling about 25% year on year as the book shrinks [6].

New-initiative spending and impairment. Giga.AI and Plus "have incurred significant losses" [1]. Goodwill and intangibles were RMB4.78bn at end-2025, and the company impaired RMB352.7m of a related investment in 2024 [1][12]. QMove is pre-revenue. Management describes spending as paced and milestone-based (secondary) [3], but no budget is disclosed.

Freight cycle, fuel and driver economics. National road freight is growing about 3% with capacity "saturated", and freight rates are flat year on year [56][72][40]. Diesel spikes, as in March–May 2026, squeeze truckers and low-value freight. Because commissions are charged as a percentage of freight, they fall with freight rates (secondary) [2][1].

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